Chemistry-resolved disagreement between Materials Project-compatible PBE(+U) and r^{2}SCAN stability verdicts in the GNoME materials database

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Abstract

GNoME reports hundreds of thousands of thermodynamically stable materials, but its labels rest on a Materials Project-compatible generalised-gradient-approximation (GGA/GGA+U) workflow, not on a functional alone. Its authors report that 84% of its discovered binaries and ternaries retain a negative decomposition energy under r^{2}SCAN, and 86.8% of tested quaternaries remain stable on the r^{2}SCAN hull. We resolve that aggregate by chemistry over the 139,541 GNoME materials released with r^{2}SCAN recomputations, a subset the dataset authors selected rather than sampled, using cluster bootstrap intervals over 8,429 structural-prototype proxy clusters.

The aggregate conceals a 26.7-point spread at fixed element count, from 4.0% [3.3, 4.7] for plain quaternary intermetallics (no lanthanide, no 3d metal) to 30.7% [27.7, 33.8] for lanthanide-free 3d-containing quaternary oxides, a pair identified post hoc against a prospectively fixed threshold. Under our reading of the release's "All" reference set, the two cells sit at 14.5% and 37.4%, preserving a 22.9-point spread while substantially reducing the ratio. Presence of a Materials Project Hubbard-U-list element is strongly associated with disagreement, conditional on the other covariates, in the fitted model over all 139,541 materials (cluster-robust odds ratio 3.45 [3.13, 3.80]). Neither selective U application nor hull proximity explains away this association under the analyses performed: disagreement stays elevated outside the U-treated regime, and a natural cubic spline in the continuous PBE decomposition energy moves the odds ratio in the 117,018-material model only from 3.53 to 3.43 [3.07, 3.83]. For allocating a verification budget, composition supplements hull proximity rather than replacing it: over held-out cluster splits at a 20% budget, the two together surface 45.8% of disagreements against 40.4% for hull distance alone. An exploratory comparison against previously catalogued materials changes direction between populations. We measure disagreement between two workflows, not accuracy.

1 Introduction

Computational materials discovery has shifted from enumerating candidates to generating them. GNoME (Graph Networks for Materials Exploration) reported 381,000 new entries on the convex hull, the surface of lowest formation energy below which a composition has no cheaper decomposition into competing phases, for a total of 421,000 stable crystals (Merchant et al., 2023); subsequent releases, which widened the release criterion from the documented on-hull tolerance of 5×10^{-5} eV/atom to within 1 meV/atom of the hull, brought the public dataset to 554,054 entries (GNoME

dataset, 2023). Generative models such as MatterGen (Zeni et al., 2025) and expanded databases such as Alexandria have followed, the latter's PBEsol/SCAN subset (Schmidt et al., 2022) using PBEsol geometries with SCAN energies rather than PBE. GNoME's own stability verdicts, which are what this paper analyses, rest on density functional theory (DFT) calculations at the Perdew–Burke–Ernzerhof (PBE) level (Perdew et al., 1996), executed in VASP (Kresse and Furthmüller, 1996) with Materials Project (MP)-compatible settings (Jain et al., 2013), including a Hubbard U for eight transition metals in oxides and fluorides and the Materials Project 2020 (MP2020) correction scheme's empirical anion and GGA/GGA+U mixing corrections (Wang et al., 2021). The functional and correction choices differ across MatterGen, Alexandria and GNoME, so the question we ask of GNoME does not transfer to the others unchanged.

GGA formation energies carry errors of order 0.1 eV/atom (Kirklin et al., 2015), but formation-energy errors do not directly determine stability-verdict disagreement, because a decomposition energy compares a material against composition-conserving combinations of competing phases rather than against an elemental reference. We therefore analyse the released decomposition-energy outcomes directly. The need for chemistry resolution is practical: a laboratory choosing which predicted compound to attempt cannot act on an aggregate error rate, a database maintainer deciding where to spend a finite recomputation budget faces the same problem at scale, and aggregate benchmark scores against PBE-derived labels (Riebesell et al., 2025) do not show how sensitivity to the workflow varies across chemistry.

GNoME's authors anticipated the question. They recomputed a subset with the r^{2}SCAN meta-GGA, the regularised-restored form of the SCAN functional (Furness et al., 2020), and reported that 84% of discovered binaries and ternaries retain negative phase-separation energies (their term for the decomposition energy), with 86.8% of tested quaternaries remaining stable on the r^{2}SCAN hull (Merchant et al., 2023). Supplementary Note 2 of that paper observes that the discrepancy concentrates near the hull and that the same effect appears in the Materials Project and the Open Quantum Materials Database (OQMD), but gives no breakdown by chemistry. The authors released the underlying r^{2}SCAN data with the statement that it is provided "expectantly serving as a foundation for analysing discrepancies between functional choices."

1.1 What this paper measures, and what it does not

We measure *disagreement between two computational methods*: a material released as stable at the PBE level whose r^{2}SCAN decomposition energy is positive (defined precisely in Section 3.4). We do not establish which functional is closer to the truth for any material, and we say nothing about whether these compounds are stable in reality. We therefore use the term *flip* throughout and avoid calling flipped labels "incorrect". Where we discuss practical consequences the operative quantity is the share of labels a higher-fidelity recomputation would revise, which is a statement about what the expensive calculation would say, not about nature. This constrains every claim that follows, including the budget model of Section 4.12, whose payoff is measured in disagreements surfaced rather than errors corrected.

1.2 Questions and contributions

1. **Q1.** Does the rate of disagreement vary systematically with chemistry, controlling for element count, and which compositional features is it associated with?

2. **Q2** (exploratory). Do GNoME materials flip at a different rate than previously catalogued materials in matched chemistry? We label this exploratory in the question list, not only in its

results section, because the two populations differ in provenance, selection and phase-diagram completeness as well as in chemistry.

3. **Q3.** Given a fixed recomputation budget, does composition add information about disagreement beyond proximity to the PBE hull, and by how much?

Our contributions are: (i) a chemistry- and element-resolved map of stability-verdict disagreement between the two workflows on GNoME; (ii) stratified comparisons showing that a lanthanide-pooled form of the composition contrast is present within every populated hull-distance band, that the 3*d*-associated excess is present within every band-gap bin, and that the contrast persists with cell size as a covariate, under inverse-probability weighting (IPW) for recomputation selection (Section 4.8), and outside the Hubbard-U-treated regime; (iii) the observation that the binary verdict change reflects a chemistry-dependent sign in the underlying energy displacement; (iv) an exploratory matched comparison against previously catalogued materials whose direction varies with composition; (v) a verification-budget evaluation over repeated cluster-wise splits showing that composition supplements rather than replaces proximity to the hull; and (vi) the observation that the compositional regime GNoME advertises most prominently is recomputed at the meta-GGA level too sparsely for stratified analysis.

Decision rules, including the threshold that would have caused us to abandon the chemistry-resolved framing, were committed to version control before the stratified analysis was run, following an earlier unstratified inspection of the data that informed the secondary lanthanide hypothesis (Section 3.7). We write "pre-committed" rather than "pre-registered" throughout: the rules were prospectively committed to a public repository, but a repository commit is not an independently timestamped registration.

2 Related work

Functional comparisons on known materials. Kingsbury et al. benchmarked r^{2}SCAN against SCAN and PBEsol across roughly 6,000 solids and found r^{2}SCAN more accurate than either for formation energies (Kingsbury et al., 2022a), and developed the mixing scheme the Materials Project uses to place PBE($+U$) and r^{2}SCAN energies on a single phase diagram (Kingsbury et al., 2022b). Two results bear directly on what follows. Kothakonda et al. tested r^{2}SCAN thermochemistry on more than 1,000 solids and concluded that for transition metals, intermetallics and weakly bound solids, GGAs are comparable to meta-GGAs, and that for the reaction class they label Type 2 decomposition enthalpies PBE is slightly more accurate (Kothakonda et al., 2023). Bartel et al. reached a compatible verdict from the reaction side: across 646 decomposition reactions that are not simply formation reactions, PBE (mean absolute error 70 meV/atom) and SCAN (59 meV/atom) perform similarly (Bartel et al., 2019). Both are statements about error magnitude against experiment, not about agreement between the two functionals: Section 4.6 shows that intermetallics flip rarely while their mean displacement is negative, which is consistent with a sign effect rather than with the functionals agreeing.

Correction schemes, chemistry-resolved error, and critiques of the release. The MP2020 scheme quantifies uncertainty in DFT energy corrections and shows that many polymorphs classified as unstable may be stable once that uncertainty is propagated (Wang et al., 2021). Warford, Thiemann and Csányi argue that applying U selectively — only when oxygen or fluorine is present — creates two mutually incompatible potential-energy surfaces within one dataset (Warford et al., 2026); Section 4.3 examines the association across that boundary. Sun et al. data-mined 29,902

observed phases to produce a chemistry-resolved scale of metastability (Sun et al., 2016), and Yu et al. map universal machine-learned interatomic potential (MLIP) formation-energy error per element across 19,998 unary and binary phases (Yu et al., 2024); both stratify a computed-energy error by chemistry, and neither addresses functional-level verdict flips in a generated candidate database. Cheetham and Seshadri question how many GNoME entries are simultaneously novel, credible and useful (Cheetham and Seshadri, 2024), Liu and Meng report that metals constitute over 60% of GNoME (Liu and Meng, 2024), and Leeman et al. examine the companion autonomous-synthesis work (Leeman et al., 2024; Szymanski et al., 2023, 2026). None of these addresses label reliability.

Flip-rate framing. The closest prior framing is Reents, Bercx and Pizzi, whose supplementary material plots a PBEsol-versus-SCAN stability flip rate against threshold for Alexandria (Reents et al., 2026). That analysis is aggregate, concerns a different database and functional pair, serves to validate a machine-learned correction, and reports no chemistry resolution. An et al. re-screened a machine-learning-generated set, finding 298 of 603 curated structures remained PBE-stable on complete hulls and 109 of 166 dynamically stable candidates survived a SCAN refinement (An et al., 2026); they excluded 142 rare-earth compounds outright because of f-electron and pseudopotential uncertainty. Huang et al. map PBE formation energies onto the r^{2}SCAN scale across 380,190 paired MatPES entries (Huang et al., 2026; Kaplan et al., 2025) but verify stability verdicts for only six binary systems. We are not aware of a prior chemistry- or element-resolved verdict-flip analysis on GNoME or any comparable generated database, and state this as the result of our own literature search rather than as an established priority claim.

3 Data and methods

3.1 Datasets

GNoME. We use two files from the public release (Merchant et al., 2023). The summary file, `stable_materials_summary.csv`, holds 554,054 unique material IDs with PBE-level decomposition energies, band gaps, space groups and cell information. The recomputation file, `stable_materials_r2scan.csv`, holds 139,541 unique IDs with r^{2}SCAN recomputations. It carries composition, element list, site count, space group and crystal system of its own, so the prototype clustering of Section 3.5 and the log-sites term of Section 4.9 are defined for all 139,541. Band gap and the PBE decomposition energy come only from the summary file, so any analysis using those is restricted to the 117,043 materials present in both, and we state the restricted n wherever it applies. Positive r^{2}SCAN decomposition energies are present throughout the recomputation file, so it is not censored to survivors.

Each file reports decomposition energy against several reference sets, which the release documents as distances to four convex hulls: *MP*, the hull of all Materials Project entries; *MP OQMD* (written MP+OQMD below), Materials Project plus OQMD entries; *All*, the hull of all entries, which the documentation says requires Materials Project, OQMD and WBM (Wang–Botti–Marques dataset) energies and which we read as also including GNoME's other structures; and *Relative*, the hull of all entries except the current one (GNoME dataset, 2023). That documentation is written for the summary file; we take the documented meanings as applying to the recomputation file's identically named columns. The released All-referenced r^{2}SCAN energies are positive for 25.8% of entries (Section 4.14), which could not occur if each entry's own energy were part of its reference hull, so we read the All column as excluding the entry itself, which on that reading makes it the leave-one-out quantity the *Relative* column was meant to hold; that column, which would otherwise be the most natural outcome, is empty in both released files. We take the MP-referenced

column as primary because it reproduces the published aggregate, report the MP+OQMD variant as a sensitivity check, and examine the "All" column separately in Section 4.14 because it gives a materially different result. The release does not document how the MP+OQMD and All hulls were built for the recomputation file; OQMD and WBM carry no r^{2}SCAN energies, so those hulls may mix functionals, and we treat rates against them as sensitivity checks rather than as hulls of known construction. Rates against "All" are computed from the recomputation file.

Of the 117,043 recomputed materials that can be matched to a PBE decomposition energy, 25 have a positive PBE value (the current release admits entries up to 1 meV/atom above the hull) and so are not PBE-stable under our ≤ 0 convention. They cannot be confirmed transitions and are excluded from every analysis that uses PBE energies; they are 0.02% of the set and no reported number changes. "PBE-stable" throughout means a non-positive MP-referenced PBE decomposition energy in the summary file, a hull of Materials Project entries; it is not the GNoME-inclusive hull on which the release's own stability claim rests.

How the r^{2}SCAN energies were produced. Each material passes through a PBE pre-relaxation with PBE54 potentials, an r^{2}SCAN relaxation and an r^{2}SCAN static calculation at `MPScanRelaxSet` and `MPScanStaticSet` settings (Merchant et al., 2023), so the structures are re-relaxed rather than evaluated at the PBE geometry, the projector-augmented-wave (PAW) datasets can differ slightly from those behind the PBE labels, and every calculation is initialised ferromagnetically. A verdict change therefore reflects the functional, the correction scheme, the PAW dataset, the relaxed geometry and possibly the converged magnetic state, together. The release does not state how the recomputed subset was chosen, nor whether any correction is applied to the r^{2}SCAN energies.

Known materials. We pull Materials Project thermo records separately for the `GGA_GGA+U` and `r2SCAN` thermo types and keep entries present in both (Appendix E gives the exact query and a spelling pitfall in the thermo type). We retrieved 37,123 r^{2}SCAN and 152,426 GGA+U documents; 35,176 material IDs carry both, of which 22,756 are stable at the GGA(+U) level and therefore capable of flipping. The `r2SCAN` thermo type is distinct from the Materials Project's mixed scheme (Materials Project, 2026b): its hull is built from whichever r^{2}SCAN entries exist in a chemical system, with no requirement that every competing phase has been recomputed (Section 4.14).

3.2 What "PBE" means here

Throughout, "PBE" denotes the Materials Project-compatible level at which GNoME's labels were produced: PBE with, for eight transition metals (V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, Mo and W; the "U list" below) in oxides and fluorides, a Hubbard U applied in the calculation, and the MP2020 scheme — implemented in the pymatgen library as `MaterialsProject2020Compatibility` — which adds empirical anion corrections and a per-atom GGA/GGA+U mixing adjustment for those same elements. It is not bare PBE. We keep the short name because it is the one the source work and the community use, but the difference between the corrected and uncorrected surfaces is the subject of Section 4.3 and should be kept in mind wherever this paper says "PBE".

3.3 Population flow

Different analyses run on different subsets, because the required fields are not available for every material. Table 1 states each population once so that the varying n throughout the paper can be traced to a stated exclusion.

Table 1: Populations used in this paper, with the exclusion that defines each.

Population	n	Defined by
Summary release	554,054	all entries in the PBE summary file
PBE-stable, ≤4 elements	365,504	decomposition energy ≤ 0, $n_{\text{el}} \leq 4$
Recomputation release	139,541	all entries in the r^{2}SCAN file
matched to the summary file	117,043	`MaterialId` present in both
matched and PBE-stable	117,018	25 matched entries were not PBE-stable
matched, PBE-stable, ≤4 elements	116,789	IPW outcome, censoring bounds (Sections 4.8, 5)
Primary composition cells	135,044	40 cells with $n \geq 500$ (Section 3.4); binaries, quinaries and hydrides all fall below the threshold
Band-gap analysis	112,434	finite positive gap (Section 4.7)
Budget evaluation	117,018	needs a PBE energy; PBE-stable
Inverse-probability weighting (IPW)	371,870	summary entries with ≤4 elements
Materials Project comparison	22,756	GGA($+U$)-stable with r^{2}SCAN thermo

The first and third rows are raw release counts; the rest are analytical. The 25 matched entries that were not PBE-stable are outside the budget evaluation and the energy-displacement analysis of Section 4.6 by construction, since both require an observed non-positive PBE energy; the IPW rate of Section 4.8 is computed on the 116,789 IPW-eligible entries, which likewise excludes them, while the 371,870 row is that model's *fitting* population and not an outcome population. The 25 are retained in the release-based rows, where they are 24 of the 135,044 primary-cell materials.

3.4 Definitions

We report two outcomes for GNoME and they must be kept apart. *Release-based disagreement* is a positive r^{2}SCAN decomposition energy for an entry of the recomputation release; it is defined for all 139,541 entries and makes no use of the PBE verdict. A *confirmed transition* additionally requires that the entry's PBE decomposition energy is observed in the summary file and is non-positive; it is defined for the 117,018 matched, PBE-stable entries. For the 22,498 entries with no summary-file row, PBE stability is *inferred* from the release's provenance and cannot be checked. Dropping the 25 observed-unstable entries moves the release-based rate from 13.041% to 13.040%; the choice is numerically immaterial, but the two outcomes are not the same quantity and we label them where both appear. We use *flip* as shorthand for release-based disagreement throughout, and rates quoted without qualification are release-based. For Materials Project entries, where `energy_above_hull` is non-negative by construction, we define stability as $E_{\text{hull}} \leq 10^{-6}$ eV/atom and flipping as GGA($+U$)-stable with $E_{\text{hull}}^{\text{r}^2\text{SCAN}} > 10^{-6}$.

We classify each composition into one of seven mutually exclusive anion classes by priority (the classes are coarse with respect to the MP2020 scheme, which corrects Si but not B or C among the boride, carbide and silicide class): oxide (contains O); halide (F, Cl, Br or I, no O); chalcogenide (S, Se or Te, none of the above); pnictide (N, P, As, Sb or Bi, none of the above); hydride (H, none of the above); boride/carbide/silicide (B, C or Si, none of the above); intermetallic (none of the above). We flag the presence of a lanthanide (La–Lu; "Ln" in tables) and of a 3d transition metal (Sc–Zn). Cells are the Cartesian product of element count, anion class, lanthanide flag and 3d flag, and are disjoint by construction. Only cells with $n \geq 500$ enter the primary analysis: forty cells qualify, holding 135,044 of the 139,541 materials. No cell is excluded by rule: the 4,497 materials outside the forty cells all sit in cells below the threshold, namely the binaries, the quinaries, the hydride class and roughly 2,000 materials in other thin cells, some of which sit at the high-flipping end, so the reported spread is if anything conservative. Per-element analyses use $n \geq 300$ and are

not restricted by element count. Secondary analyses apply further minimum counts stated where they are used: 100 known materials per matched cell, 100 element-containing materials per class, and 200 materials per hull-distance band.

3.5 Materials are not independent observations

GNoME is substitution-generated: the authors attribute 232,477 of 381,000 stable structures to symmetry-aware partial substitution (Merchant et al., 2023). Materials sharing a parent structure and differing by one or two ionic substitutions are not independent samples of chemical space, and may share relaxation behaviour, competing phases and systematic error.

We quantify this using a structural-prototype proxy: the pair (space group number, anonymised stoichiometry), where anonymised stoichiometry replaces element identities with sorted site counts, so that $Nd_7Os_1Pr_3Si_5$ becomes A1B3C5D7. The 139,541 recomputed materials fall into **8,429 such clusters**, mean size 16.55; the five largest hold 2,953 to 1,122 materials, and 87.5% of all materials sit in clusters of ten or more. The intra-cluster correlation of the flip outcome is $\rho = 0.138$. The equal-size design-effect formula $1 + (\bar{m} - 1)\rho$ with $\bar{m} = 16.55$ gives 3.15; the unequal-size formula $1 + (\sum_g m_g^2/n - 1)\rho$ gives 46.3, because five clusters hold 7.7% of the data. Neither approximation is used for inference. Their implied standard-error multipliers are approximately 1.77 and 6.80; the empirical interval-widening factors, from the cluster bootstrap described below and from a cluster-robust sandwich estimator, are 1.82 for the median composition cell and 2.77 for the U-list coefficient.

Every interval attached to a GNoME flip rate in this paper is a cluster bootstrap interval: we resample prototype clusters with replacement, not individual materials, at 20,000 replicates for cells and for the per-element analysis and 100,000 for the within-anion excesses (Appendix C gives the count for each analysis). One population is not clustered this way and is labelled where it appears: the Materials Project entries of Section 4.11, for which the thermo fields we retrieved carry no structural information our clustering key could use. Across the 40 primary cells the observed widening relative to naive intervals has median 1.82 and ranges from 1.17 to 5.16 (Appendix A). Point estimates are unaffected; only the intervals are. The odds-ratio intervals of Section 4.9 come from the cluster-robust sandwich estimator rather than a bootstrap; its average marginal effects use 1,000 cluster bootstrap refits. Where a table gives point estimates without intervals it is descriptive and no claim in the text rests on the precision of those numbers.

The prototype proxy is a choice, so we test it. Clustering on anonymised stoichiometry alone, ignoring space group (2,186 clusters, mean size 63.8), leaves the headline quaternary contrast essentially unaffected: 30.7% [27.4, 34.0] against 4.0% [3.3, 4.7], compared with 30.7% [27.7, 33.8] against 4.0% [3.3, 4.7] under the primary definition. Dropping the five largest clusters (10,730 materials, 7.7% of the set) moves the headline contrast from +26.7 to +26.8 points, the 20 largest to +27.3 and the 50 largest to +28.2, so the largest clusters are if anything diluting it.

3.6 Multiple comparisons and regression uncertainty

The per-element analysis performs 83 tests. We compute Benjamini–Hochberg adjusted p-values for the contrast between each element's flip rate and the global rate. The contrast is resampled jointly, so that each replicate recomputes both rates from one drawn set of clusters (Appendix C); with $\hat{D}_e$ the bootstrap difference between the element rate and the global rate, the p-value is the two-sided normal-approximation tail $2\left(1 - \Phi\left(|\hat{D}_e|/\mathrm{se}(\hat{D}_e)\right)\right)$, with se the standard deviation of the resampled differences, and the Benjamini–Hochberg step-up is applied to the 83 resulting values. The primary

cell-level comparison and the lanthanide hypothesis were pre-committed; the per-element analysis was not, and is treated as exploratory despite surviving correction.

Logistic regression coefficients are fitted by iteratively reweighted least squares, with standard errors from a cluster-robust sandwich estimator: with $r_g = y_g - \hat{p}_g$ the residual vector of cluster g and $s_g = X_g^\top r_g$ its score contribution, $\hat{V} = B \left(\sum_g s_g s_g^\top \right) B$ with $B = (X^\top W X)^{-1}$ and $W = \mathrm{diag}(\hat{p}(1-\hat{p}))$, clustering on the same structural prototypes used for the bootstrap; no finite-cluster correction is applied in this model, since with 8,429 clusters the factor is negligible (the hull-distance-adjusted fits of Table 6 and the context model of Section 4.4 apply it; Appendix C). Relative to naive analytic errors this inflates the standard error on the U-list coefficient by a factor of 2.77, between the two design-effect approximations above.

3.7 Pre-committed decision rules

The pre-committed primary rule, evaluated on cells with $n \geq 500$ at fixed element count, was: a spread of ≥ 5 percentage points between the highest and lowest cell with non-overlapping intervals supports a standalone analysis; a spread below 3 points, or intervals that all overlap, folds the result into a single parameter reported elsewhere; a spread of 3 to 5 points proceeds only if the comparison against known materials shows a separate effect. The file specifies naive bootstrap intervals with 1,000 resamples; the cluster intervals reported here are wider, and the rule's conditions hold under both. The secondary pre-committed claim was that lanthanide-containing materials would flip at or below the global rate at fixed element count, to be counted as refuted if they flipped above it. They do, within each element count and pooled (11.8% against 13.0%), on point estimates. We record three problems with that test rather than bank its result. The comparator was badly chosen: lanthanide-containing materials are 59.4% of the recomputed set, so the global rate is largely their own (against non-lanthanide materials the gap is 11.8% against 14.8%). And the marginal contrast is almost entirely composition: once anion class is held fixed the regression gives an odds ratio of 1.02 [0.93, 1.12], with the sign of the association reversing between anion classes (Section 4.10). And the hypothesis was itself informed by the earlier unstratified inspection of these data (Section 1.2), so its confirmation is not an out-of-sample prediction. The pre-committed claim is confirmed as stated and uninformative as posed.

The rules and the results were committed in that order, at `82d49db` and `c11ccf2` respectively, in the public repository. This is a sole-authored repository and git commit timestamps are set by the committer, so the ordering is asserted by the author and attested by nobody; it should be read as a description of how we worked rather than as independent certification. What the repository does establish is content: the decision rules in `DECISION_RULES.md` are those paraphrased above, and the thresholds were not adjusted once the spread was known.

4 Results

4.1 The aggregate figure reproduces, and conceals a 26.7-point spread at fixed element count

Across all 139,541 recomputed materials the flip rate is 13.04% against the Materials Project hull, 15.93% against MP+OQMD, and 25.8% against the most inclusive reference set. Validating against the source requires matching its populations rather than its headline. Restricted to quaternaries our survival rate (one minus the flip rate) is 87.35% against the reported 86.8%, a gap of about half a point; pooled over binaries and ternaries it is 85.34% against the reported 84%, a gap of 1.3 points. The source reports these shares without sample sizes or the reference hull behind them, so

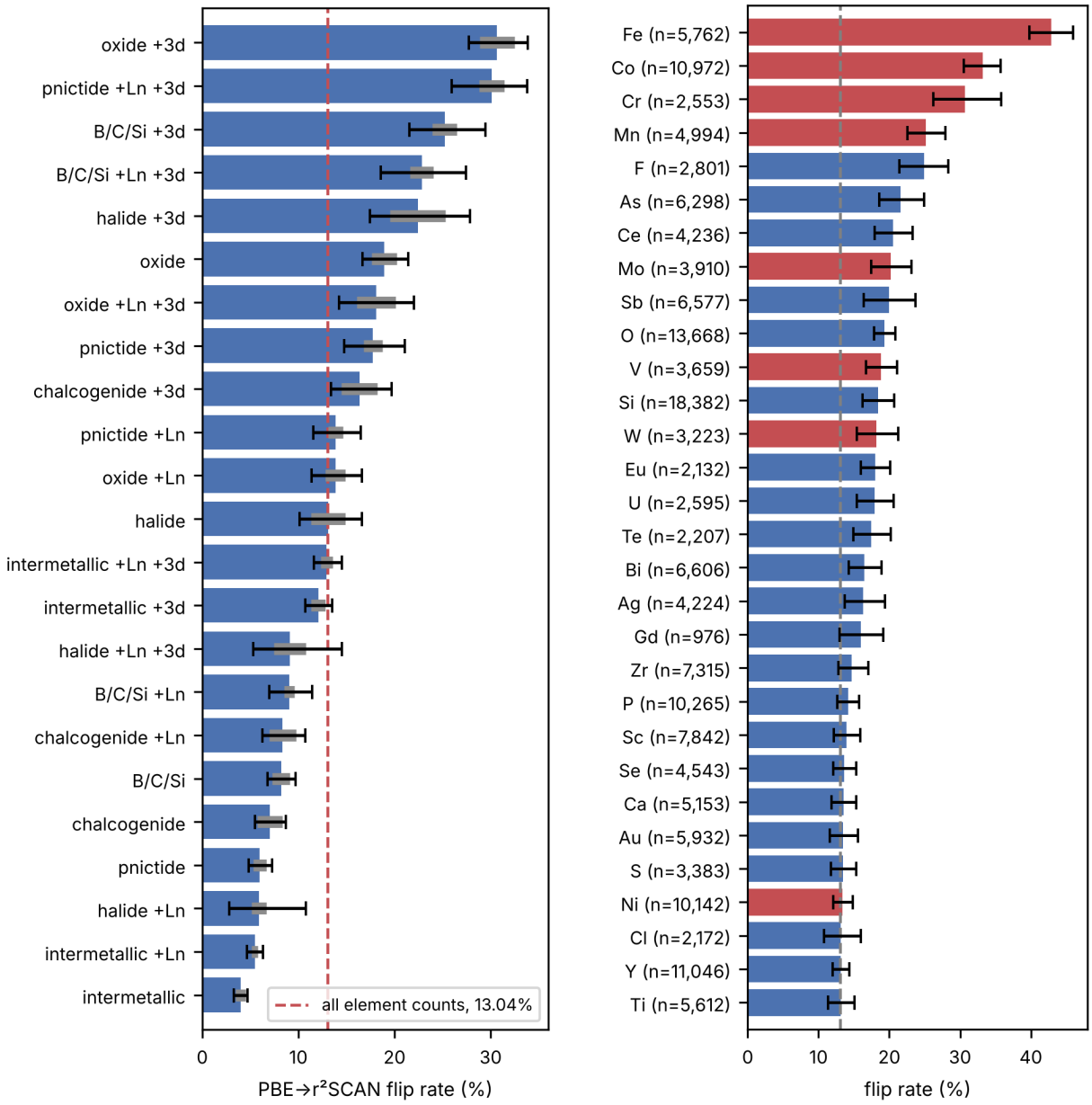


Figure 1: **Left:** flip rate by composition cell for quaternary GNoME materials. Cells are disjoint; B/C/Si abbreviates boride/carbide/silicide. Black bars are cluster bootstrap 95% intervals; the grey bars behind them are the naive Wald binomial intervals, shown to make the size of the correction visible. The dashed line in both panels marks the flip rate over all element counts, 13.04%, as labelled in the left-panel legend; the quaternary-only marginal is 12.65%. **Right:** per-element flip rate, 30 highest of 83 elements with $n \geq 300$, with cluster bootstrap 95% intervals. Red bars mark the eight elements receiving a Hubbard U in oxides and fluorides in the MP-compatible workflow.

agreement to within about one point is the most this comparison can establish; the residual gaps are consistent with the reference hull having been rebuilt since publication, and we do not claim exact agreement.

Resolved by chemistry at fixed element count, the picture changes entirely (Figure 1, left; full table with cluster bootstrap intervals in Appendix A). Among quaternary materials, 23 cells qualify and the flip rate ranges from 4.0% [3.3, 4.7] for plain intermetallics containing neither a lanthanide nor a $3d$ metal (n = 5,025) to 30.7% [27.7, 33.8] for $3d$-containing oxides without a lanthanide (n = 2,478). The spread of 26.7 points is more than five times the pre-committed threshold and the intervals remain disjoint under clustering. The highest-minus-lowest spread is a selected extremum and we report it descriptively: the pre-committed rule fixed the decision threshold before the analysis was run, but it does not make the realised pair a prespecified pairwise contrast, and we attach no multiplicity-corrected p-value to it. Ternaries show a comparable spread of 23.9 points across 17 cells. The ordering is compatible with prior chemistry-dependent benchmarking (Kothakonda et al., 2023) without being predicted by it, since comparable accuracy against experiment does not imply agreement between two workflows.

4.2 Per-element rates against the MP reference span a factor of thirty, 7.5 among non-f elements

Computing the flip rate for every element appearing in at least 300 recomputed materials (83 elements; Figure 1, right; full table in Appendix B) gives a sharper picture. Iron-containing materials flip at 42.8% [39.8, 46.0] (n = 5,762, 1,218 prototype clusters). Cobalt follows at 33.2% [30.5, 35.7], chromium at 30.7% [26.2, 35.8] and manganese at 25.2% [22.6, 27.9]. At the other end, the lowest are actinium at 1.4% [0.9, 2.0], protactinium at 3.6% [2.6, 4.8] and promethium at 4.4% [0.8, 9.3] (n = 389, an interval that overlaps the next entries), with technetium and magnesium tied at 5.7%. Of the 83 element-level contrasts against the global rate, 53 remain significant after Benjamini–Hochberg correction at the 0.05 level, and at 20,000 replicates the same 53 survive under every bootstrap seed we tried (Appendix C). The 30 that do not are the elements whose element-minus-global contrast is not distinguishable from zero; that is a statement about the difference and not about the rate itself.

Three cautions apply. Per-element rates are not disjoint: an iron oxide counts toward both Fe and O, so an element's rate is confounded with the anion classes in which it tends to occur, and Section 4.3 reports instead the *excess* flip rate associated with Fe, Co and Ni within each anion class. The two lowest entries are actinides (Ac, Pa), which carry an f-electron caveat analogous to the lanthanides' (Section 4.10), so the factor-of-thirty range should not be over-read; among non-f elements it is a factor of 7.5. And the correspondence with the Materials Project U list is imperfect: nickel sits at 13.4%, essentially the global average, and Section 4.3 shows its excess does not sit where a U-suppression account predicts.

4.3 Elevated disagreement persists outside the Hubbard-U-treated regime

PBE labels carry the MP2020 corrections; the r^{2}SCAN side carries no documented correction (Section 3.1). If the gradient simply tracked where those corrections are applied, it would be an artefact of bookkeeping. The anion corrections (Materials Project, 2026a) attach to the anion rather than to the transition metal, so comparing Fe-containing against Fe-free materials of the same anion class differences out most of their effect, though not exactly, since whether a species receives the correction depends on its chemical role. The Hubbard U is the opposite: it applies to V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, W and Mo, only in oxides and fluorides (Warford et al., 2026; Materials Project, 2026a), and it acts on the cation, which is why a within-class Fe-present against Fe-absent contrast is the sharpest handle on it the released data offer. We recompute no corrections anywhere in this work. Three comparisons examine whether the association follows the U boundary.

First: the regime with no U. Among compositions containing neither oxygen nor fluorine, quaternary materials containing one of the eight U-list elements flip at 21.9% (n = 29,482), those whose only 3d elements are Sc, Ti, Cu or Zn at 7.2% (n = 14,649), and those with no 3d element and no Mo or W at 7.4% (n = 54,795); ternaries give 28.4%, 10.8% and 9.6% (n = 5,245, 3,102 and 15,765). The same three groups within oxides and fluorides, where the U is applied, flip at 32.8%, 19.7% and 13.7% for quaternaries (n = 4,009, 1,246 and 7,633). The groups are mutually exclusive and are the same indicators as the regression's 3d encoding (Appendix C). The Sc/Ti/Cu/Zn group shows an excess confined to oxides and fluorides (19.7% against 13.7%, but 7.2% against 7.4% elsewhere) that neither the U reading nor the magnetism reading below covers; we list it with molybdenum and tungsten as unexplained.

Second: across the U boundary directly. Within each anion class (Table 2), the iron excess is smallest in oxides, where Fe receives a U, and largest in borides, pnictides and intermetallics, where it does not; the oxide and boride intervals are far from overlapping. Cobalt's oxide excess is likewise among its smallest and indistinguishable from zero (+4.6 [−1.0, +11.7]); its halide excess is smaller still. Nickel runs the other way: its largest excesses are in chalcogenides (+14.2 [+6.9, +23.8]) and oxides (+10.3 [+3.8, +17.5]), with a small excess in intermetallics (+2.0 [+0.3, +3.7]) and none distinguishable from zero in pnictides, borides or halides. The oxide iron excess, +5.0 [+0.5, +10.1], is the iron interval with the least margin from zero; its lower endpoint is stable across bootstrap seeds (Appendix C) but sits close to zero, so we rest nothing on its excluding zero. What the section argues from is the gap between that excess and the +29 to +47 intervals in borides, pnictides and intermetallics, where iron receives no U.

Table 2: Excess flip rate associated with the presence of Fe, Co or Ni, within each broad composition class. The classes are coarse and their members differ in more than the transition metal, so these are associations rather than causal element effects. "Without" is the flip rate of materials in the same class lacking that element; the excess is in percentage points (pp), computed from unrounded rates. The oxide row, the only class in which Fe receives a U throughout, is set in bold; fluorides, a minority of the halide row, also receive it (third comparison below). Intervals are cluster bootstrap intervals over structural prototypes, 100,000 replicates; one draw per replicate serves all three elements. Classes with fewer than 100 element-containing materials are omitted, which removes the Fe-hydride row only. The final column gives the same contrast as an odds ratio, since a percentage-point excess is compressed where the baseline is high; the bottom of the ordering — oxide lowest, halide next — is unchanged on either scale.

Anion class	n with Fe	With Fe	Without Fe	Excess, pp [95% CI]	OR
boride/carbide/silicide	1,268	54.0%	13.0%	+41.0 [+35.4, +47.0]	7.88
pnictide	1,264	50.3%	15.0%	+35.3 [+29.8, +40.6]	5.75
intermetallic	1,904	42.2%	8.0%	+34.2 [+29.4, +39.1]	8.38
chalcogenide	154	41.6%	11.5%	+30.0 [+17.7, +44.8]	5.46
halide	476	24.4%	10.9%	+13.5 [+5.8, +22.4]	2.64
oxide (U applied)	610	24.1%	19.1%	**+5.0** [+0.5, +10.1]	1.35
Co: boride +34.0 [+28.0, +39.6], intermetallic +22.2 [+18.5, +25.9], pnictide +22.0 [+17.8, +25.6], chalcogenide +15.8 [+9.4, +24.2], hydride +9.7 [−0.8, +22.9], oxide +4.6 [−1.0, +11.7], halide −0.7 [−6.0, +6.4]					
Ni: chalcogenide +14.2 [+6.9, +23.8], oxide +10.3 [+3.8, +17.5], hydride +6.0 [−4.1, +19.4], intermetallic +2.0 [+0.3, +3.7], pnictide −1.5 [−5.1, +2.2], boride −2.2 [−5.2, +1.0], halide −2.1 [−6.2, +4.7]					

Third: fluorides against the other halides. The MP-compatible input set applies U in oxides *and fluorides*, so within the halides, fluorine-containing materials receive it on the U-list metals and the chloride, bromide and iodide materials do not. The iron excess is +8.8 points among fluorine-containing halides against +16.3 among the rest, and the manganese excess +2.4 against +21.5, the direction of the oxide result in both cases. The subsets are small ($n = 78$ Fe-fluorides, 170 Mn-fluorides), the two halide subsets differ in halogen chemistry as well as in U treatment, and cobalt fluorides ($n = 30$) are too few to split, so this is corroboration rather than independent evidence. That fluorine-containing halides flip at 24.8% overall against 7.2% for the rest is a difference in class baseline; the quantity the U argument concerns is the within-class excess contributed by a U-list metal, +6.3 points among fluorides and +7.8 among the other halides, a contrast that is nearly flat; the per-element contrasts above are what carry the direction.

Reading. The version of the selective-U hypothesis tested here is that disagreement produced by the $+U$ treatment would concentrate in the oxide and fluoride chemistry where U is applied. Elevated disagreement persists outside that regime, and the iron-associated within-class excess is largest there (the pooled U-list excess itself is not smaller where U is applied: +19.1 points in oxides and fluorides against +14.5 outside, from the first comparison), so selective U application is not a sufficient explanation. What follows is an association across composition classes, not a controlled intervention — oxides, borides, pnictides and intermetallics differ in bonding, oxidation state, magnetic behaviour, competing phases and reference coverage, not only in whether a U is applied — so we write that the smaller excesses in oxides are *consistent with* partial suppression by the corrected treatment, and we do not claim that applying U causes the gradient to shrink. Reference coverage is a further alternative: on the Materials Project side the r^{2}SCAN hulls of oxides are the least complete of any class (Section 4.14), and incompleteness understates flips for iron-containing and iron-free oxides alike, compressing the excess. Where U is applied, the iron excess shrinks from the +34 to +41 range of the classes receiving no U (and +13.5 in the halides, where only fluorides receive it) to +5.0; cobalt's oxide excess is small, but so is its halide excess in a class that mostly receives no U; nickel runs the other way (Table 2); and on the continuous scale of Section 4.4 the oxide context is the lowest for Fe and Cr but the highest for Co. The partial-suppression reading therefore holds for iron, is ambiguous for cobalt, and does not hold for the U list as a whole. The highest within-class rates in Table 2 are iron in borides, pnictides and intermetallics, chemistry that receives no U, which is where Warford et al. identify the uncorrected potential-energy surface (Warford et al., 2026); this is a statement about U specifically, since chalcogenides receive a full anion correction and still show a +30.0-point iron excess.

What the operative variable might be. An element-presence indicator cannot separate Hubbard-U-list membership from 3d magnetism. One mechanism is well documented and is a plausible candidate for what we observe, though we compare no candidates and rank none. SCAN-family meta-GGAs overestimate magnetic moments and magnetic stabilisation in itinerant 3d systems. For the elemental ferromagnets, Ekholm et al. (2018) report that SCAN "performs worse than standard local and semilocal functionals" for fcc Ni and hcp Co. Fu and Singh (2018) describe a degradation relative to PBE across V, Co, Ni and Pd, and in Fe_3C obtain 6.87 μ_B per three-iron formula unit under SCAN against 5.75 under PBE and a room-temperature saturation value of 5.3, an excess of about 30% over experiment. Mejía-Rodríguez and Trickey (2019) trace the elemental over-magnetisation, about 20% in bcc Fe, to the iso-orbital indicator; Tran et al. (2020) find it in intermetallic ferromagnets generally; and Kothakonda et al. (2023) find it stronger under r^{2}SCAN than under SCAN, with iron's moment overestimated by 24% against SCAN's 17%. A functional

that over-stabilises the magnetic state displaces a metallic compound and its competing phases by different amounts, which is what a decomposition energy measures. Three features of our results are consistent with that: the Fe, Co, Cr, Mn ordering at the top of the per-element rates; the concentration of the iron and cobalt excess in borides, pnictides and intermetallics, classes that are predominantly metallic; and its near-absence in oxides, where moments are typically more localised under both treatments. These are class-level tendencies, not material-level evidence. Nickel's position near the global average is also consistent, because its spin-up d bands are virtually filled already under PBE (Ekholm et al., 2018), though that accounts for the average and not for its reversed anion-class pattern. Molybdenum and tungsten at 20.2% and 18.2% are non-magnetic $4d$ and $5d$ metals and we leave them unexplained. Because the release initialises every calculation ferromagnetically (Merchant et al., 2023), the two workflows may additionally converge to different magnetic states. We have not tested this mechanism and do not claim it: the released files carry no magnetisation field, and the discriminating calculation is a spin-polarised against non-spin-polarised comparison on a small set of iron and cobalt borides and pnictides with their competing phases.

Separately, we asked which element set best discriminates the released outcomes, refitting a reduced form of the regression of Section 4.9 with the MP U list, its $3d$ subset alone, and an alternative $3d$ indicator that drops Mo and W and adds Cu. The Cu-including indicator fits worst (log-likelihood $-50{,}590$ against $-50{,}472$ for the U list and $-50{,}329$ for its $3d$ subset); copper-containing materials flip at 12.6%, below the global 13.0%, so adding copper dilutes the indicator. The $3d$ subset fits best of the three at equal parameter count. We nevertheless keep the full U list as the headline encoding because it names the correction scheme's own element set and is the encoding used throughout; the difference between the two is a matter of Mo and W. We did not resolve oxidation states, so this concerns which element set best discriminates the outcomes and not electronic occupancy.

4.4 Element coefficients vary with anion context in the fitted model

A natural objection is that the chemistry dependence might be per-element bookkeeping: if r^{2}SCAN's elemental reference energies were offset for the magnetic $3d$ metals, every compound containing them would shift. That mechanism is excluded by construction, because a decomposition energy is evaluated at fixed composition: an additive shift δ_e in element e's reference contributes $\sum_e x_e \delta_e$, with x_e the atomic fraction of element e, to the compound and the identical amount to the competing combination, and cancels. What the argument does not cover is an error in the computed energy of a particular competing phase, including an elemental metal that is itself a decomposition product: an over-stabilised bcc iron raises the decomposition energy of every compound that decomposes to it, and does not cancel. The broader question is whether Δ, the per-material r^{2}SCAN-minus-PBE displacement of the decomposition energy defined in Section 4.6, is an additive function of composition. A naive test fails here: our cells are *defined* by element presence, so an additive per-element model spans nearly the same space as the cell indicators, and removing its fit collapses the cell gradient in Δ essentially to zero — collinearity, not evidence. The discriminating question is whether a given element contributes differently in different company. Allowing Fe, Co, Ni, Mn and Cr to interact with anion class improves the fit by $\Delta R^2 = 0.009$ on $n = 117{,}018$ with 30 added terms, and the fitted contributions spread widely (Table 3): iron's is -31 meV/atom per unit atomic fraction in oxides and $+208$ in chalcogenides, a spread of 239 meV/atom where the additive model constrains it to be constant; at a realistic iron fraction of 0.1 to 0.25 that is 24 to 60 meV/atom between contexts, between one-and-a-half and four times the cell-level mean shifts of Section 4.6. The design is full rank (113 columns, condition number 7.0×10^2), so every within-element contrast is identified (Appendix C). We read the table as a descriptive fit rather than a

calibrated test of additivity, because Δ contains the correction removal by construction, so a fitted level is not an element's physical contribution.

Table 3: Fitted contribution to Δ per unit atomic fraction (meV/atom), by element and anion context, from the ordinary-least-squares model of Appendix C: $\Delta \sim \sum_e c_e x_e + \sum_{e \in S} \sum_a \gamma_{ea} x_e \mathbb{1}[\text{class} = a]$, with x_e the atomic fraction of element e, $S = \{\text{Fe, Co, Ni, Mn, Cr}\}$ and a the six non-hydride anion classes. The entry shown is $c_e + \gamma_{ea}$, and an additive model constrains each row's spread to be zero in the population. The spread interval is a cluster bootstrap over structural prototypes (Appendix C); between the two seeds the endpoints move by up to 13 meV/atom, so they should be read to about ± 10. The interval describes uncertainty in a fitted spread and is not a test of additivity; for that, see Table 4.

Element	oxide	halide	chalc.	pnictide	bor./carb./sil.	interm.	Spread	95% CI
Fe	−31	+195	+208	+143	+157	+80	239	[161, 334]
Cr	+8	+58	+257	+108	+119	+178	249	[144, 404]
Mn	+62	+263	+196	−10	+45	+40	273	[196, 338]
Ni	+84	+71	+27	−8	−3	+19	92	[45, 206]
Co	+92	+86	+78	+56	+70	+67	36	[23, 97]

For Fe and Cr the oxide context is the lowest of all, the same context-dependent association reported in Section 4.3 expressed on the continuous scale and not independent confirmation of it; for Co the oxide context is the highest (+92), so the suppression pattern is not reproduced for cobalt on this scale; the two elements with the smallest fitted spreads are Co and Ni, at 36 [23, 97] and 92 [45, 206] meV/atom against 239 to 273 for Fe, Cr and Mn.

Because each spread is a data-selected maximum-minus-minimum statistic, the bootstrap intervals are not calibrated tests of the additive null. For that we use a cluster-robust Wald test that an element's six interaction coefficients are equal, five degrees of freedom each, with Benjamini–Hochberg correction across the five elements (Table 4). Within this post-selected element set and fitted specification, four reject equal context coefficients: nickel at $\chi^2 = 94.8$, manganese at 71.6, iron at 70.3 and chromium at 31.7. Cobalt does not, at $\chi^2 = 8.2$ and $p = 0.15$, even though its spread interval excludes zero — exactly the over-rejection a selected-range statistic produces.

Table 4: Cluster-robust Wald test of the joint null that an element's six interaction coefficients are equal, against the alternative that at least one anion context differs. Five degrees of freedom each; the covariance is the cluster-robust sandwich over the 7,822 structural prototypes with the finite-cluster correction of Appendix C, which is immaterial at this cluster count and omitted in the logistic model; the threshold is Benjamini–Hochberg (BH) at 0.05 across the five elements, applied in ascending p order.

Element	χ^2_5	p	BH threshold
Ni	94.75	6.8×10^{-19}	0.010
Mn	71.63	4.7×10^{-14}	0.020
Fe	70.31	8.8×10^{-14}	0.030
Cr	31.71	6.8×10^{-6}	0.040
Co	8.15	0.148	0.050

4.5 The gradient survives within every populated hull-distance band

The most obvious alternative explanation for Section 4.1 is proximity. Materials close to the PBE hull need only a small energy change to cross it; if 3*d* oxides sit nearer the hull than intermetallics, they will flip more often for no reason connected to the functional, and Supplementary Note 2 of the source work reports that disagreement concentrates near the hull. Testing it was pre-committed as one of the robustness gates listed in `DECISION_RULES.md`.

Table 5 stratifies quaternary materials by PBE decomposition energy. Flip rate rises steeply toward the hull in every cell (monotonically in all but the 3*d*-free intermetallic column, whose two deepest bands are 0.8% and 0.5%), confirming the Note 2 observation: 3*d*-free intermetallics (lanthanide pooled) go from 0.5% in the $(-0.1, -0.05]$ band to 15.9% in $(-0.01, 0]$. And the chemistry gradient is present inside every band: in $(-0.05, -0.02]$, 3*d* oxides flip at 23.1% and 3*d*-free intermetallics at 1.2%; in $(-0.01, 0]$, 40.1% against 15.9%. The within-band spread between those two cells is roughly 11, 22, 25 and 24 points across the four populated bands. The cells do differ in position (median PBE decomposition energy −20.8 meV/atom for 3*d* oxides against −22.4 for 3*d*-free intermetallics).

Table 5: Quaternary flip rate by PBE decomposition energy band and composition cell. Cells with fewer than 200 materials in a band are shown as a dash; counts in parentheses. These cells pool the lanthanide flag, because the lanthanide-resolved cells are too thin to stratify further by band, so the oxide+3*d* minus 3*d*-free-intermetallic contrast here is smaller than the 26.7 points of Section 4.1. Column counts differ from the quaternary cell totals of Section 4.8 by at most ten materials per cell.

PBE band (eV/atom)	oxide+3*d*	oxide	pnictide+3*d*	pnictide	interm.+3*d*	interm.
≤ -0.1	—	3.9% (563)	5.5% (494)	0.5% (794)	2.0% (402)	0.8% (930)
$(-0.1, -0.05]$	11.1% (443)	6.1% (1,063)	14.6% (1,748)	1.3% (2,364)	3.2% (1,987)	0.5% (2,710)
$(-0.05, -0.02]$	23.1% (1,070)	15.5% (2,132)	19.8% (3,608)	8.2% (3,810)	7.9% (6,709)	1.2% (7,777)
$(-0.02, -0.01]$	29.4% (744)	24.3% (1,159)	28.3% (1,752)	20.8% (1,970)	16.0% (3,947)	4.3% (4,512)
$(-0.01, 0]$	40.1% (802)	27.8% (1,142)	37.7% (1,493)	27.0% (1,442)	27.2% (3,263)	15.9% (4,937)

Binning leaves residual variation in distance inside each band, so Table 6 removes the bins. It refits the composition model of Section 4.9 with a natural cubic spline in the continuous PBE decomposition energy, on the 117,018 materials for which that quantity is observed and non-positive, with cluster-robust standard errors over the 7,822 structural prototypes present in that subset. The covariate is the summary file's MP-referenced decomposition energy, so both sides of the comparison use the same reference set (the two hulls themselves differ by functional). The adjustment is substantial and the chemistry association survives it. Hull distance more than doubles the model's pseudo-R^2, from 0.068 to 0.156, so proximity carries a great deal of information that composition does not; the U-list odds ratio nevertheless falls only from 3.53 [3.19, 3.92] to 3.43 [3.07, 3.83]. Every anion-class term moves the other way, oxide from 2.63 to 3.16 and pnictide from 1.93 to 2.58, consistent with those classes, taken as a whole, sitting farther from the hull than the reference class, so that the unadjusted rate understates their association and adjusting for position strengthens rather than explains it. Adding interactions between hull proximity and chemistry shows the two interact: U-list by proximity is 0.52 [0.43, 0.63] and oxide by proximity 0.62 [0.50, 0.76], where proximity increases toward the hull, so the chemistry multiplier compresses as the hull is approached while the gap in percentage points widens up to the penultimate band and is roughly flat in the last, because the baseline rate rises much faster.

Table 6: Composition odds ratios with and without a flexible continuous adjustment for distance below the PBE hull, on the 117,018 materials with an observed non-positive PBE decomposition energy. The spline is a five-column natural cubic basis (truncated-power form with linear tails) with knots at the sextiles of that energy, columns standardised. Intervals are cluster-robust over the 7,822 structural prototypes in this subset. The reference class is a lanthanide- and 3*d*-free hydride or intermetallic; element-count and log-sites terms are included in both fits but not shown.

	no hull-distance term	natural spline in PBE hull distance
U-list element present	3.53 [3.19, 3.92]	3.43 [3.07, 3.83]
other 3*d* present	1.12 [0.99, 1.25]	1.07 [0.96, 1.20]
lanthanide present	1.12 [1.01, 1.23]	1.01 [0.91, 1.12]
oxide	2.63 [2.27, 3.05]	3.16 [2.69, 3.72]
pnictide	1.93 [1.69, 2.20]	2.58 [2.22, 2.98]
halide	1.27 [0.98, 1.65]	1.97 [1.51, 2.59]
chalcogenide	1.40 [1.18, 1.65]	1.66 [1.38, 2.00]
boride/carbide/silicide	1.78 [1.51, 2.09]	2.34 [1.94, 2.83]
McFadden pseudo-R^2	0.068	0.156

4.6 r^{2}SCAN shifts chemistries in opposite directions

A flip is a binary summary of a continuous quantity, $\Delta = E_{\mathrm{dec}}(\mathrm{r^2SCAN}) - E_{\mathrm{dec}}(\mathrm{PBE})$, where the subtrahend carries the MP2020 corrections and the Hubbard-U treatment and the minuend carries no documented correction. Δ is therefore the net displacement from corrected GGA(+U) to uncorrected r^{2}SCAN, not a pure functional difference, and we write "r^{2}SCAN moves X" as shorthand for that net displacement. The distributions differ between chemistries in both mean and dispersion (Table 7). The mean changes sign: r^{2}SCAN destabilises 3*d* oxides by +14.7 meV/atom on average and stabilises plain intermetallics by −8.9, with every 3*d*-containing cell sitting above its 3*d*-free counterpart, and the share of materials moving upward broadly tracks the mean, from 61.1% to 31.0%. The within-cell standard deviations, 23.8 to 55.7 meV/atom, exceed the magnitudes of the mean displacements in every displayed cell, and the quartiles straddle zero in every cell: this is a displacement of a wide distribution, not a uniform translation, and for any individual material Δ is dominated by scatter. Flips occur where an upward shift carries a near-hull material across zero, which is why they concentrate in the cells with positive mean Δ. Kothakonda et al. find GGA and meta-GGA "comparable" for intermetallics (Kothakonda et al., 2023), and Bartel et al. find PBE and SCAN similarly accurate on decomposition reactions generally (Bartel et al., 2019); our data add that the mean displacement differs in sign between chemistries. Whether r^{2}SCAN's stabilisation of intermetallics or its destabilisation of 3*d* oxides is the more accurate direction is a question about experiment that this paper does not address.

4.7 The 3*d* contrast persists across band-gap bins

Band gap is a natural candidate for mediating the effect, since U-list compounds are disproportionately narrow-gap. The gap is recorded in the summary file rather than the r^{2}SCAN file, so it exists only for materials present in both. Of the 139,541 recomputed materials, 22,498 have no summary-file row and a further 2,320 have the field empty, neither of which we treat as insulators; 2,177 carry an infinite sentinel; 112 are stored as the literal `0.0`, which the release does not distinguish from a value rounded or clipped to zero and which form a bin too small to split on 3*d* content; and 112,434 carry a finite positive gap and enter Table 8. A single-threshold split loses most of the variable's

Table 7: Change in decomposition energy from PBE to r^{2}SCAN, on the primary cell definition (quaternary, no lanthanide), restricted to the 117,018 materials that carry a PBE decomposition energy and are PBE-stable. Cell definitions are identical to Section 4.1; counts are correspondingly 6% to 20% smaller. Positive values mean r^{2}SCAN moves the material toward instability. All entries are in meV/atom; Q1 and Q3 are the quartiles of Δ.

Cell	n	mean	median	s.d.	Q1	Q3	share $\Delta > 0$
oxide + 3d	2,085	+14.7	+5.4	55.7	−8.3	+28.6	61.1%
bor./carb./sil. + 3d	4,167	+12.9	+6.4	35.6	−5.9	+26.8	60.6%
chalcogenide + 3d	1,272	+8.1	+2.6	37.9	−6.6	+14.5	56.8%
oxide	2,748	+6.8	+3.1	49.5	−11.1	+22.2	57.1%
pnictide + 3d	5,145	+4.5	+0.7	39.1	−10.7	+17.5	51.5%
halide + 3d	658	+3.4	−0.8	36.0	−14.1	+15.9	49.1%
intermetallic + 3d	7,023	−0.1	−1.5	28.7	−10.1	+7.4	44.5%
halide	1,126	−3.8	−4.8	29.8	−16.2	+6.6	38.2%
bor./carb./sil.	3,120	−3.8	−1.9	31.4	−13.7	+11.6	44.0%
chalcogenide	1,234	−4.6	−2.7	27.7	−14.2	+5.5	39.5%
pnictide	4,043	−6.2	−2.7	31.2	−14.1	+5.9	40.8%
intermetallic	4,628	−8.9	−4.1	23.8	−14.2	+1.5	31.0%

structure, since the marginal rate is not monotone in the cut point (entries with gaps below 0.01 eV flip at 13.6% and those between 0.01 and 0.5 eV at 9.6%, two groups the first bin of Table 8 merges), so we resolve it into bins.

Table 8: Flip rate by PBE band-gap bin, split on 3d content. Descriptive; no intervals are attached and no claim of equality across bins is made.

Band gap (eV)	n, no 3d	Flip	n, 3d	Flip	3d excess (pp)
0–0.5	58,958	8.5%	41,097	19.0%	+10.5
0.5–1	1,834	8.7%	901	18.3%	+9.6
1–3	4,719	15.0%	2,166	25.3%	+10.4
> 3	2,208	18.9%	551	30.7%	+11.8

Reading across the last column, the 3d excess lies between +9.6 and +11.8 points in every displayed bin, so the 3d-associated contrast persists across the bins. Reading down the no-3d column, the rate more than doubles from 8.5% at narrow gaps to 18.9% above 3 eV, so a gap association is present at fixed 3d content. These are four descriptive bin comparisons with no intervals attached; the 3d wide-gap cell is the least well populated in this table ($n = 551$), and other composition differences remain within bins — among the wide-gap, 3d-free materials the halides flip at 27.4% and the oxides at 16.5%, so anion class may carry part of the gap trend. We report band gap as a second axis along which disagreement varies and do not attempt to adjudicate between the two.

4.8 Selection into the recomputed subset

The recomputed subset is not a random sample. We fit a logistic model of recomputation on composition, element count, cell size and PBE decomposition energy (linear and quadratic) across the 371,870 $\leq$4-element materials, of which 116,814 (31.4%) were recomputed, 116,789 after removing the 25 PBE-unstable entries. Selection is chemistry-dependent: oxides are more likely to be re-

computed (odds ratio 1.64), as are borides, carbides and silicides (1.58) and pnictides (1.43), while lanthanide-containing materials (0.68) and larger cells (0.65 per standard deviation of log sites) are less likely.

The contrast changes little under the specified propensity model. The naive rate over the 116,789 recomputed, PBE-stable ≤4-element entries is 13.36%, and the weighted estimate on that IPW-eligible population is 12.71%. The spread across lanthanide-pooled quaternary cells moves from 22.0 to 21.9 percentage points (Table 9); cell-level estimates move by at most 2.4 points, the ordering of the seven tabulated cells is preserved, and two untabulated cells each swap with an adjacent tabulated cell. Inverse-probability weighting corrects only for selection on the observed features entered into the model; if the authors selected on something we cannot see, it does not correct for it. The weights need their own accounting (Appendix C): fitted propensities over the 365,504 PBE-stable ≤4-element entries fall to the underflow limit of the fit, $e^{-500} \approx 7.1 \times 10^{-218}$ (on entries that were not recomputed; among recomputed entries the minimum is 1.52×10^{-6}), indicating severe estimated lack of overlap, and the estimate depends on a propensity floor of 10^{-2}, below which 26 recomputed entries fall. Untrimmed, Kish's effective sample size collapses to 5; at the floor it is 83,875 (71.8% of n), and floors of 2×10^{-2} and 5×10^{-2} give 12.74% and 12.76%. We report 12.7% as a sensitivity result conditional on this model and this floor, not as a corrected population rate.

Table 9: Quaternary cells with the lanthanide flag pooled (as in Table 5), naive against inverse-probability-weighted flip rate. Selected rows; full table in the repository. Rates are computed on all 116,814 recomputed entries with at most four elements, including the 25 that are not PBE-stable. Spreads are computed from unrounded rates.

Cell	n	Naive	IPW
oxide, 3d	3,178	27.2%	27.2%
boride/carbide/silicide, 3d	7,947	25.2%	25.8%
pnictide, 3d	9,097	22.6%	24.6%
oxide, no 3d	6,059	16.8%	16.7%
intermetallic, 3d	16,318	13.0%	13.1%
halide, no 3d	4,302	7.2%	8.1%
intermetallic, no 3d	20,871	5.3%	5.3%
Spread		**22.0 pp**	**21.9 pp**

Crystal system and cell size. By crystal system, flip rates run from 16.8% (triclinic) to 11.1% (hexagonal), with cubic at 14.3% and the rest between 12.6% and 13.2%; the triclinic excess is plausibly a proxy for low-symmetry structures being harder to relax consistently, but we have not established that. By cell size, rates range from 11.3% (≤10 sites) to 16.3% (>32 sites), not monotonically; in the regression below the size term is not significant once composition is controlled for.

4.9 A logistic model over composition

Table 10 reports a logistic regression of flip probability on composition features across all 139,541 materials.

The presence of a U-list element is associated with 3.45 times the *odds* of a flip. An odds ratio is not a risk ratio: at the reference baseline of about 6% the corresponding probability ratio is 3.0.

Table 10: Logistic regression of flip probability. Reference category pools intermetallics with hydrides, both lacking a 3*d* metal and a lanthanide; hydrides are 1.3% of the set, and their flip rate (12.0%) sits above the 3*d*- and lanthanide-free intermetallic rate of 4 to 8% for ternaries and quaternaries (14% for the 92 binaries). Refitting this specification with the hydride rows dropped moves the *U*-list odds ratio from 3.448 to 3.468, the other-3*d* term from 1.101 to 1.104 and the lanthanide term from 1.023 to 1.022; no odds ratio moves by more than 0.023. $n = 139{,}541$; McFadden pseudo-$R^2 = 0.066$. The exponentiated intercept is the baseline odds for the reference category, not an odds ratio. Intervals are cluster-robust (sandwich estimator on structural prototypes). The final column gives the inflation of the standard error relative to the naive analytic value.

Feature	Coefficient	Odds ratio*	Cluster-robust 95% CI	SE inflation
Intercept (baseline odds)	−2.780	0.062	[0.056, 0.068]	2.24×
MP *U*-list element	+1.238	3.448	[3.129, 3.799]	2.77×
Other 3*d* (Sc, Ti, Cu, Zn)	+0.096	1.101	[0.984, 1.232]	1.98×
Lanthanide present	+0.023	1.023	[0.933, 1.121]	2.73×
Oxide	+0.903	2.467	[2.161, 2.815]	2.43×
Pnictide	+0.666	1.946	[1.700, 2.228]	3.00×
Boride/carbide/silicide	+0.518	1.678	[1.437, 1.959]	3.32×
Chalcogenide	+0.335	1.399	[1.205, 1.624]	1.97×
Halide	+0.286	1.330	[1.047, 1.691]	3.42×
Element count (*z*-scored)	−0.177	0.838	[0.807, 0.870]	2.32×
log sites (*z*-scored)	+0.015	1.015	[0.958, 1.075]	3.44×

* For the intercept row this column is the baseline odds, not a ratio.

As an average marginal effect, computed from the interaction model of the next paragraph with 1,000 cluster bootstrap refits, the presence of a *U*-list element is associated with a flip probability 15.4 points higher [+14.2, +16.6], a comparison of *U*-list present against all *U*-list-absent materials pooled.

Lanthanide content has an odds ratio of 1.02 with an interval straddling unity, and that should not be read as "lanthanides do not matter". The model above has no interactions, so a single lanthanide coefficient averages effects of opposite sign. Adding lanthanide × anion and *U*-list × anion interactions improves the fit by a likelihood-ratio χ^2 of 879 on 14 degrees of freedom (in a reduced specification without the other-3*d* and site-count terms, with hydride as its own class), read as descriptive since it assumes independent observations. The model-based average marginal effect of lanthanide content, from the interaction model with cluster bootstrap intervals, is −8.3 [−11.4, −4.8] in halides, −7.8 [−10.7, −4.9] in oxides and +8.9 [+6.5, +11.6] in pnictides, while the pooled effect over all classes is +0.2 points [−0.7, +1.2]; the unadjusted within-class differences, pooled over all element counts, are −9.9, −9.2 and +7.0 points. The sign reversal is the one reported nonparametrically in Section 4.10. Element count enters negatively — each standard deviation reduces the odds by about 16% — consistent with the marginal rates (binaries 19.8%, ternaries 14.6%, quaternaries 12.7%).

Three cautions. McFadden's pseudo-R^2 is 0.066, low on its own scale: what supports using composition for allocation is the held-out ranking performance of Section 4.12, not this number, and readers should not use this table to decide whether a specific compound's label is wrong. Correcting for clustering inflates every standard error by roughly 2 to 3.5 times; the *U*-list association survives with a wide margin, while the halide term survives only narrowly (1.330 [1.047, 1.691]). And the *U*-list indicator aggregates eight chemically distinct elements, two of which (Mo, W) are not 3*d* at all, so we describe *U*-list membership as a strong observed compositional predictor and not as an

identified physical mechanism.

4.10 The lanthanide effect reverses sign with the anion

Lanthanide treatments raise a well-known *accuracy* concern, but that concern does not by itself predict a high rate of *disagreement* between two workflows that may share similar approximations, and we keep the two apart. The concern is shared by An et al., who excluded 142 rare-earth compounds from their stability screen on exactly these grounds (An et al., 2026), and frozen-f pseudopotentials are documented, for the norm-conserving PseudoDojo tables, as appropriate only where the f electrons are chemically unimportant (van Setten et al., 2018); that documentation concerns a different potential family from the PAW datasets VASP uses, and the release does not state its lanthanide PAW datasets, so the applicability of the concern to this dataset specifically remains an assumption rather than a checked fact.

Lanthanide-containing materials have a below-global release-based disagreement rate, 11.8% against 13.0%, which is the direction we pre-committed on the strength of an unstratified cut made before the decision rules were written. That does not establish the adequacy of either workflow: agreement between two workflows cannot rule out an error they share. And the matched-cell comparison shows the average is misleading. Among quaternary $3d$-containing materials, lanthanide-containing cells have *lower* rates in halides (9.1% against 22.4%) and oxides (18.1% against 30.7%) and a *higher* rate in pnictides (30.1% against 17.8%); among quaternaries without a $3d$ metal, the lanthanide-containing pnictide cell sits at 13.9% against 6.0%. The sign depends on the anion. A flip in lanthanide chemistry is not evidence that r^{2}SCAN is correct, and the absence of one is not evidence that either treatment is adequate: the disagreement is a flag, not a verdict.

4.11 Matched against known materials, the aggregate comparison inverts

GNoME materials flip at 13.0%; Materials Project entries computed at both levels flip at 14.9%, so at face value the GNoME entries appear *more* robust to the choice of functional. This runs opposite to the source paper's own aggregate comparison (84% survival against the Materials Project's 90%), which uses different populations and reference hulls.

Twenty cells hold at least 500 GNoME and 100 known materials and so enter the comparison. GNoME disagrees more in 14 and less in 6, which on a two-sided exact sign test is not itself significant ($p = 0.115$); what carries the result is the standardised contrast reported below, together with the fact that 10 of the 20 differences have intervals excluding zero and show a chemistry-structured descriptive pattern: the two negative contrasts whose intervals exclude zero are intermetallic cells (Table 11; all twenty in Figure 2 and Appendix D). The 20 comparisons carry no multiplicity correction, so we label the comparison exploratory; it is the weakest inferential step in the paper. The GNoME side is a cluster bootstrap drawn across all twenty cells at once, since 45% of the prototypes spanning these cells appear in more than one; the Materials Project side is resampled at the material level, because the thermo fields retrieved carry no structural information. Material-level resampling on the GNoME side instead would narrow the intervals by a median factor of 1.28 and move one cell's interval from including to excluding zero. The largest deficits are quaternary $3d$ oxides (+17.3 points), ternary $3d$ chalcogenides (+12.5) and ternary $3d$ borides, carbides and silicides (+11.3); the largest advantages are plain ternary intermetallics (−7.7) and ternary lanthanide intermetallics (−6.6).

The aggregate figures and the matched cells run in opposite directions, and the difference comes from which cells are compared. Within the twenty matched cells GNoME disagrees *more*, 15.50% against 14.01%; standardised to the known-materials cell mix the difference is +1.23 points [+0.22,

Table 11: Matched cells, GNoME against Materials Project previously catalogued materials; the ten of twenty whose intervals exclude zero. n_G and n_K are the GNoME and known-material counts; the GNoME rate is release-based and the known rate is a confirmed transition (Section 3.4). Positive δ means GNoME disagrees more; δ is computed from unrounded rates. Intervals are percentile intervals from 20,000 replicates: the GNoME side is a cluster bootstrap over structural prototypes drawn across all twenty cells at once, the Materials Project side a material-level bootstrap. No multiplicity correction is applied and the comparison is exploratory.

Cell	n_G	GNoME	n_K	Known	δ	95% CI
4-el oxide, 3*d*	2,478	30.7%	180	13.3%	+17.3	[+11.4, +23.0]
3-el chalcogenide, 3*d*	564	30.3%	450	17.8%	+12.5	[+6.0, +19.4]
3-el bor./carb./sil., 3*d*	575	29.6%	454	18.3%	+11.3	[+4.6, +18.0]
3-el halide, no Ln/3*d*	1,326	17.3%	1,125	9.2%	+8.2	[+4.7, +11.9]
4-el oxide, no Ln/3*d*	3,318	18.9%	297	10.8%	+8.2	[+3.9, +12.4]
3-el oxide, no Ln/3*d*	921	21.7%	1,553	16.7%	+5.0	[+1.4, +8.6]
3-el pnictide, no Ln/3*d*	1,473	11.1%	852	6.9%	+4.1	[+1.3, +7.1]
3-el chalcogenide, no Ln/3*d*	1,106	10.6%	1,064	7.4%	+3.2	[+0.5, +6.0]
3-el intermetallic, Ln	4,661	6.4%	1,988	13.0%	−6.6	[−8.7, −4.5]
3-el intermetallic, no Ln/3*d*	2,618	7.9%	1,144	15.7%	−7.7	[−10.2, −5.3]

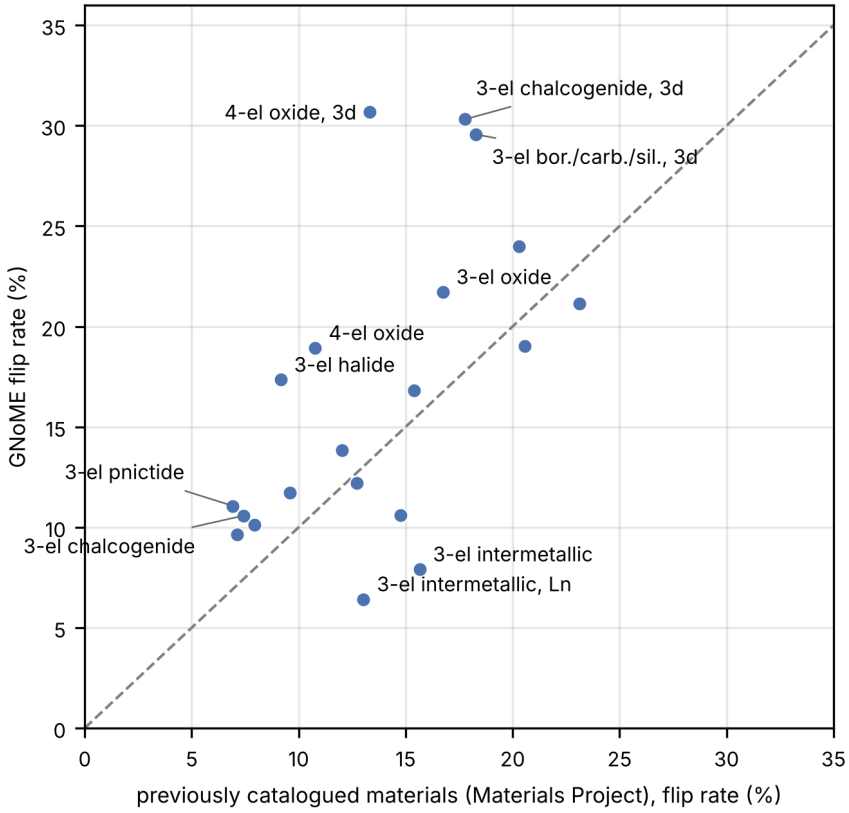


Figure 2: Workflow disagreement in matched composition cells. Points above the diagonal are cells where GNoME materials disagree more than previously catalogued materials of the same broad composition class and element count; labels mark the ten cells whose intervals exclude zero, and an unqualified label denotes a lanthanide- and 3*d*-free cell. Higher disagreement is not lower accuracy.

+2.28] and to the GNoME mix +1.85 [+0.57, +3.11], both excluding zero (bootstrap means; the plug-in standardised differences are +1.22 and +1.84). What differs in sign is the comparison between the *full* populations: the full release is 9.8% oxide where the matched-cell GNoME population is 33.3% oxide, so restricting to cells the known materials also populate upweights oxides roughly threefold. That is a descriptive decomposition of two rates, not a demonstration that composition *causes* the difference. The Materials Project side is a confirmed transition while the GNoME side above is release-based; re-evaluating the GNoME side on the confirmed-transition basis leaves seventeen cells (three fall below 500 GNoME materials on that basis) with standardised differences of +1.33 [+0.18, +2.51] and +2.25 [+0.83, +3.66], the same answer slightly more strongly.

An incomplete r^{2}SCAN hull omits competing phases and so understates flip rates on either side. On the Materials Project side, the r^{2}SCAN hulls of known oxides are the least complete of any anion class (median 37% of competing GGA entries recomputed) and those of intermetallics the most complete among the large classes (64%, Section 4.14); completing the Materials Project side alone could shrink the +17-point gap in $3d$ oxides or leave it unchanged, so the +17 is an upper figure only in the weak sense that this one-sided operation cannot exceed it, and not a bound on a comparison in which both sides are completed. In intermetallics, GNoME's own hulls gain most in proportional terms from the denser all-entries reference, so part of its −7.7-point advantage there may be incompleteness on the GNoME side. The comparison is also not matched on distance below the PBE hull, the single covariate most likely to confound it; the Materials Project thermo documents expose `decomposition_enthalpy` (Bartel et al., 2019), so the omission is ours; we leave it to a follow-up rather than add an unregistered analysis at this stage. The defensible claim is therefore: *within the analysed datasets, functional-level disagreement differs between GNoME and previously catalogued materials in a chemistry-dependent manner, and the direction of the aggregate comparison differs from that seen in several matched composition cells.* It is not a claim that the mode of discovery as such makes a material's label more or less reliable.

4.12 Verification budgets: composition adds to hull distance

If flip rates are predictable from composition, a maintainer with a limited r^{2}SCAN budget should not sample uniformly. Uniform sampling, however, is a weak thing to beat, and there is an obvious competitor that costs nothing: the PBE decomposition energy itself, already known for every candidate. Section 4.5 shows that flips concentrate steeply toward the hull. Any claim for composition-aware allocation has to be made against that baseline, so we evaluate four policies.

The population for the budget evaluation is the 117,018 recomputed materials that carry a PBE energy and were PBE-stable, in 7,822 prototype clusters, half of which form the estimation set and the rest the evaluation set. **The split is by cluster, not by material**. The composition policy estimates a flip rate for each (element count, anion class, lanthanide, $3d$) cell from the estimation set only and ranks evaluation materials by it, ties broken by a seeded permutation; the hull-distance policy ranks by PBE decomposition energy, closest first, with no estimation step; the combined policy ranks by the fitted probability from a logistic regression of the flip outcome on the estimated cell rate and the hull distance, fitted on the estimation set. A budget b selects the first $\lfloor bN \rfloor$ of the N evaluation materials, and the *catch* is the share of the evaluation set's flips that the selection surfaces; uniform random selection has expected catch b. The procedure is repeated over 20 cluster-wise splits (full statement in Appendix C); the across-split spread describes how much the answer moves with the split and is not a confidence interval, and the budget counts entries, not compute.

The ordering is the result (Table 12, Figure 3). Ranking by composition alone surfaces 37.6% of disagreements at a 20% budget against 20.0% for uniform sampling, but ranking by hull distance alone does better still, at 40.4%, and at every budget we tested. **A maintainer who used this**

Table 12: Share of flipped labels surfaced at a given recomputation budget, under four ranking policies. Mean over 20 cluster-wise splits; standard deviation across splits in brackets; the uniform-random column is the analytic expectation and carries none; the best policy at each budget is in bold. Hull distance alone outperforms composition alone at every budget; the two together outperform either.

Budget	Uniform random	Composition	Hull distance	Both
5%	5.0%	11.2% [0.5]	12.9% [0.3]	**14.3%** [0.5]
10%	10.0%	20.8% [0.8]	23.0% [0.7]	**26.5%** [0.9]
20%	20.0%	37.6% [1.0]	40.4% [0.9]	**45.8%** [1.1]
30%	30.0%	50.0% [0.9]	54.8% [0.8]	**61.6%** [1.0]
50%	50.0%	71.0% [1.0]	77.0% [0.8]	**84.0%** [0.6]

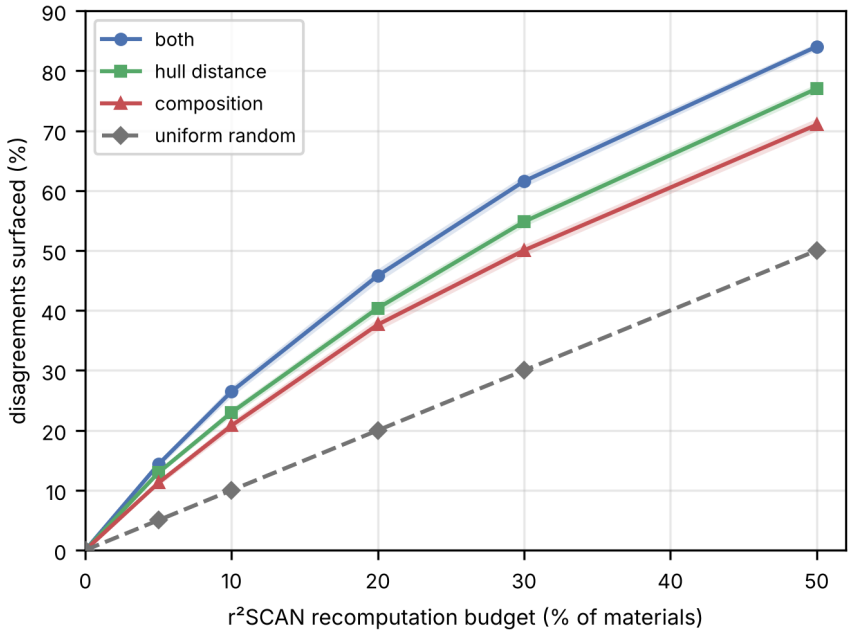


Figure 3: Disagreements surfaced against recomputation budget under four ranking policies, anchored at zero budget. Means over 20 cluster-wise splits; the shaded bands, ±1 standard deviation across splits, are barely wider than the lines.

paper's chemistry cells in place of the PBE energy already in their database would be worse off. Because the policies share the same 20 splits, the paired per-split differences are the relevant uncertainty: hull distance beats composition by +2.75 points at a 20% budget (paired s.d. 1.43, direction held in 20 of 20 splits) and the combined policy beats hull distance alone by +5.42 points (paired s.d. 1.39, 20 of 20 splits). What composition does do is add to hull distance: the two together surface 45.8% at a 20% budget, and the gain persists at every budget and widens in absolute terms as the budget grows. Closest-first ranking uses the variable without fitting anything, so composition might only be standing in for a better-modelled hull distance. On 20 cluster-wise splits drawn afresh (the first coincides with the first split above) we therefore added a hull-distance-only logistic model over twenty quantile bins of PBE depth, and a cross-fitted combined model in which the estimation half is split five ways by prototype cluster. The twenty-bin hull model did

not improve held-out catch over closest-first ranking (-0.06 points at a 20% budget); against it the combined policy is ahead by $+6.00$ points (paired s.d. 0.80, 20 of 20) and the cross-fitted combined policy by $+6.31$ (paired s.d. 0.78, 20 of 20). Composition still adds after hull distance is modelled nonparametrically, and the gain persists under cross-fitting, which is evidence against generated-regressor optimism rather than proof that none is present. We claim neither that the combined policy is optimal nor that its per-entry probabilities are calibrated: the evaluation measures held-out ranking performance.

4.13 Robustness

Threshold. A material counts as disagreeing when $E_{\mathrm{dec}}(\mathrm{r^2SCAN}) > \tau$, with $\tau = 0$ in the rest of the paper, on the release-based population of Section 3.4. We recomputed rates for τ from 0 to 50 meV/atom in 5 meV/atom steps (Appendix F). Oxides rank first and the intermetallic class last at every threshold, which is the contrast the paper's claims rest on; the middle of the ordering reshuffles, with chalcogenides falling from fourth to sixth of the seven classes between 0 and 5 meV/atom. Reporting against threshold rather than at a single cut follows Reents et al. (2026).

Reference set. The contrasts we tested hold against both the MP and MP+OQMD hulls; across the 40 primary cells the MP+OQMD rate runs 1.1 to 5.1 points higher (median 2.4), and the cell ordering is nearly preserved (Spearman $\rho = 0.99$; 30 of 780 pairwise orderings invert, all between cells whose intervals overlap). The "All" reference set behaves differently and is treated in Section 4.14.

Pseudopotentials. GNoME used newer PAW potentials for Li, Na, Mg, Ge and Ga, and its MP-referenced hull applies per-atom corrections to Materials Project entries containing those elements (GNoME dataset, 2023). Materials containing them flip *less* (11.0% against 13.5%). That is a marginal association over compositions differing in much more than the potential used, and it does not exclude a pseudopotential contribution, which would require a within-composition comparison we have not run.

4.14 Hull completeness, probed on both sides

The release documents its "All" column as the distance to the convex hull of all entries (GNoME dataset, 2023), which we read as GNoME's own structures alongside the Materials Project, OQMD and WBM entries (Section 3.1). Rates against it are measured against a denser reference, and the global flip rate is 25.8%, roughly double the MP-referenced figure. A more complete hull can only raise decomposition energies, and "All" raises them everywhere. The chemistry that gains the most in proportional terms is intermetallics (Table 13), whose rate rises from 9.2% to 22.3%, a factor of 2.4 — and in the headline cell from 4.0% to 14.5%; in percentage points the boride, carbide and silicide class gains slightly more (15.0% to 29.6%). That is consistent with the MP-referenced hull being least complete for intermetallics, the class to which GNoME added the largest number of new phases, but it is not a measurement of completeness: a denser hull does not identify *which* phases were added to *which* chemistry, and a larger change in a binary flip rate can also reflect how many materials sit near the classification boundary, so the observed quantity is the rate's sensitivity to the reference-set definition.

The gradient survives, but in a weaker form than the threshold check of Section 4.13 found — oxides drop from first to third among the three highest classes (29.5% against 29.6% and 29.6%) and intermetallics are no longer the lowest class (22.3% against 21.6% for chalcogenides) — while the oxide-to-intermetallic ratio compresses from 2.1-fold under the MP reference to 1.3-fold under "All".

Table 13: Anion-class flip rate against the MP reference hull and the "All" reference set.

Anion class	n	MP reference	"All" reference
oxide	13,668	19.3%	29.5%
pnictide	26,330	16.7%	29.6%
boride/carbide/silicide	25,732	15.0%	29.6%
chalcogenide	7,849	12.1%	21.6%
hydride	1,827	12.0%	22.3%
halide	9,840	11.5%	24.2%
intermetallic	54,295	9.2%	22.3%

We report these as estimates under two reference-set definitions, not as bounds, since two observed choices do not bracket the chemistry effect; what the comparison establishes is that the effect is substantially reference-set sensitive. We kept the MP reference as primary because it reproduces the source paper's published aggregate, not because it gives the larger spread.

Table 14 answers the narrower question on the two cells the abstract quotes. Both rates rise under "All" — from 30.7% to 37.4% for lanthanide-free 3d-containing quaternary oxides, and from 4.0% to 14.5% for lanthanide-free 3d-free quaternary intermetallics — so the ratio compresses from 7.67-fold to 2.58-fold while the absolute spread falls only from +26.7 to +22.9 points, with an interval of [+19.7, +26.3] far from zero. The headline contrast survives the alternative reference set; what does not survive is its magnitude as a ratio.

Table 14: The two headline composition cells under both reference-set definitions. The "All" intervals and both spread and ratio intervals are cluster bootstraps over structural prototypes at 20,000 replicates, with one prototype draw per replicate shared across the two cells. The MP-reference cell rates are given as point estimates only; their intervals are the per-cell draws of Appendix A.

	n	MP reference	"All" reference
oxide, no Ln, 3d (4-el)	2,478	30.7%	37.4% [34.6, 40.4]
intermetallic, no Ln/3d (4-el)	5,025	4.0%	14.5% [12.9, 16.1]
spread (pp)		+26.7 [+23.5, +29.9]	+22.9 [+19.7, +26.3]
ratio		7.67 [6.29, 9.52]	2.58 [2.26, 2.97]

The Materials Project side can be inspected directly. For each of the 22,756 known materials in Section 4.11 we define r^{2}SCAN hull completeness as the fraction of GGA(+U) entries in the material's chemical system and all of its subsystems, excluding the material itself, that also carry an r^{2}SCAN thermo document. This counts every entry rather than the phases that define the hull, but it is a direct count, and it varies strongly with chemistry (Table 15): oxides have the lowest median coverage of any class and intermetallics the highest among the large classes, opposite to what the "All" comparison would suggest for GNoME's own hulls. When the known materials are split into completeness terciles (cut at 46.2% and 61.1%), the flip rate for materials containing a 3d element is 21.5%, 19.8% and 18.7% against 13.4%, 9.9% and 13.4% for materials without one, an excess of +8.2, +9.9 and +5.3 points that remains above +5 in the most complete tercile; within the lowest tercile, the only one holding more than a handful of 3d oxides (1,205, against 9 and 0 in the other two), they flip at 21.0% against 14.6% for plain intermetallics ($n = 315$). Stratifying on the coverage we can count does not remove the 3d-associated contrast; it does not establish that the contrast is free of a completeness artefact.

Table 15: Materials Project side: median r^{2}SCAN hull completeness and flip rate by anion class, for the 22,756 GGA(+U)-stable materials with r^{2}SCAN data.

Anion class	n	Median completeness	Flip rate
oxide	4,065	37.0%	17.0%
intermetallic	7,954	64.1%	16.4%
pnictide	2,801	53.3%	15.2%
halide	2,634	58.2%	13.0%
boride/carbide/silicide	2,365	42.0%	12.1%
chalcogenide	2,704	58.5%	11.7%
hydride	233	67.3%	9.4%

5 Selection effects

Beyond the propensity analysis of Section 4.8, two coverage features constrain what can be claimed.

Element count. Coverage is 12.9% for binaries, 31.8% for ternaries and 31.4% for quaternaries, then collapses to 0.13% for quinaries (229 of 177,392) and zero for senaries (0 of 4,792). GNoME highlights discovery in combinatorial spaces of five or more elements (Merchant et al., 2023), and quinaries make up 32% of the released dataset, yet the recomputed coverage there is insufficient to support the stratified claims we make for ternaries and quaternaries. Our logistic model finds disagreement risk *decreasing* with element count, but extrapolating a fitted trend past the edge of the data is exactly the move this paper argues against.

Distance to the hull. Over all 554,054 summary entries, coverage peaks at 26.1% in the $(-0.1, -0.05]$ eV/atom band (it is 18.3% below -0.2 and 25.8% in $(-0.2, -0.1]$) and declines monotonically from there toward the hull, to 16.5% in $(-0.01, 0]$ and 0.3% above zero. These band coverages pool all element counts, so part of the gradient is the element-count effect just described; the propensity model of Section 4.8 enters both. Either way, the recomputed subset under-samples precisely the region where flips are most likely. Taken alone that would make the observed rate an underestimate of the population rate, but that model includes PBE decomposition energy alongside composition and cell size, and the net effect of weighting is to move the estimate *down*, from 13.36% to 12.71%. We did not decompose that net change into per-feature contributions, and we claim no direction for the overall selection bias.

Censoring bounds. Of the $N = 365{,}504$ summary-file entries that are PBE-stable and have at most four elements, $n = 116{,}789$ were recomputed, among which $F = 15{,}608$ flipped. Treating every unrecomputed entry among the N as unflipped gives $F/N = 4.3\%$; treating every one as flipped gives $(F + (N - n))/N = 72.3\%$. These bounds do not identify a useful population rate, as any worst-case bound on 68% censoring cannot. The 12.7% propensity-weighted result is reported separately as a model-dependent sensitivity analysis, not as a replacement for those bounds.

Unmatched identifiers. 22,498 r^{2}SCAN material IDs do not appear in the current summary file. Their distribution over anion class and element count is close to that of the matched remainder, and their flip rate is 2.0 points lower (11.4% against 13.4%), which does not suggest selective omission of high-disagreement entries. One element is affected wholesale: every ytterbium-containing entry in the r^{2}SCAN file (6,265 of them, 28% of the unmatched set) lacks a summary-file row, so no

PBE-matched analysis contains ytterbium. We state a release-version mismatch as a hypothesis (Appendix E). Including or excluding them changes no conclusion.

6 Discussion

For users of generated catalogues. A single aggregate reliability figure is insufficient for chemistry-specific prioritisation. A group screening GNoME oxides faces a 19.3% rate of verdicts that r^{2}SCAN would overturn against 9.2% for intermetallics, and narrowing to the cell widens the gap further: quaternary lanthanide-free 3d oxides flip at 30.7% against 4.0% for the corresponding plain intermetallics. We suggest datasets of this kind ship a per-entry verification-priority score rather than a global statistic, combining proximity to the hull with composition, in that order of importance (Section 4.12); what is demonstrated here is ranking performance, and calibrated per-entry probabilities would be a separate objective. The rates above are those of the analysed GNoME cells and should not be carried over to other databases or to benchmark test sets.

For benchmark design. Benchmarks such as Matbench Discovery evaluate MLIPs against a PBE hull (Riebesell et al., 2025), correctly for their purpose of measuring whether a model reproduces DFT. If a model is scored on how well it reproduces PBE verdicts, the chemistry composition of the test set determines how much of the score reflects agreement with labels a higher-fidelity functional would overturn: within the GNoME cells we analyse, roughly 30% for lanthanide-free 3d quaternary oxides and roughly 4% for the corresponding plain intermetallics. We make no claim about any particular benchmark result.

For MLIP training data. Warford et al. argue that selectively applied U splits a training set into incompatible surfaces (Warford et al., 2026). Section 4.3 shows that label disagreement is associated with the element set they identify, though our comparisons do not establish the correction as its cause. Warford et al. report that datasets omitting $+U$ entirely, such as MatPES (Kaplan et al., 2025) and MP-ALOE (Kuner et al., 2025), avoid the issue (Warford et al., 2026); nothing here tests that.

What would settle the physics. Our evidence is statistical: U-list content predicts disagreement; the 3d-associated excess persists within band-gap bins, the cell contrast within hull-distance bands, the cell contrast under inverse-probability weighting for recomputation selection, and the U-list association under adjustment for cell size and across the U boundary itself. We do not show *why* the two functionals disagree for these materials; that requires a targeted study of a small number of systems at higher levels of theory.

7 Limitations

Hull completeness is the largest partially resolved threat. An r^{2}SCAN convex hull omits any competing phase for which no r^{2}SCAN calculation exists, *understating* flip rates; the pure r^{2}SCAN thermo type we query does not guard against this as the Materials Project's mixed scheme does (Materials Project, 2026b), and the GNoME decomposition energies were computed against hulls we cannot inspect. If reference-phase coverage varies systematically with chemistry, part of the gradient could reflect differential hull completeness. Section 4.14 is a partial probe: under the "All" reference set the oxide-to-intermetallic ratio falls from 2.1 to 1.3 while oxides remain among the three highest classes, and the 3d-associated contrast persists within each tested entry-coverage

stratum on the Materials Project side. A direct test on the GNoME side would require the dataset authors' hull construction, which is not released.

Neither functional is ground truth. r^{2}SCAN is more accurate than PBE for formation energies on average (Kothakonda et al., 2023), and than SCAN and PBEsol (Kingsbury et al., 2022a), but not uniformly: for transition metals and intermetallics PBE and r^{2}SCAN are comparable (Kothakonda et al., 2023), PBE and SCAN perform similarly on decomposition reactions (Bartel et al., 2019), and for copper SCAN and r^{2}SCAN over-stabilise Cu^{2+} relative to Cu^{+}, an error that PBE+U avoids but that a U added to SCAN does not repair (Bae et al., 2025); the Materials Project applies no U to copper, so GNoME's copper labels carry no U and neither workflow benefits from that repair. A low flip rate for a chemistry says only that the two functionals agree there.

Clustering is corrected but the proxy is imperfect. Our prototype proxy will merge genuinely distinct structures sharing a space group and stoichiometry pattern and split related structures that relaxed into different space groups, and because compositions are not reduced, the same compound released as A_2B_4 and as AB_2 would receive different patterns. A true prototype assignment via structure matching would be better. The headline result is unchanged under a coarser definition and under removal of the largest clusters (Section 3.5), and we claim no direction for the residual error.

The model supports ranking, not per-material prediction. McFadden's pseudo-R^2 is 0.066, and the held-out evaluation of Section 4.12 supports the model's ability to *rank* materials rather than to assign calibrated per-entry probabilities. We have not assessed calibration.

Selection of the candidates themselves is not resolved. GNoME's candidates were filtered for PBE stability by a PBE-trained model, so the released set may be enriched for structures where PBE happens to be favourable — a winner's curse that would predict elevated flip rates with no chemistry-functional interaction required. The release supports two internal probes, the generation pipeline (`Data Directory`) and training-set membership (`Is Train`): using lanthanide-pooled cells, oxide+3d minus 3d-free intermetallic is +20.0 and +22.3 points across the pipeline split and +21.6 and +19.4 across the training-set split. Four contrasts spanning 2.9 points, with no intervals, make a weak test, and it does not exclude a shared chemistry-dependent selection process, since a common energy displacement need not produce equal changes in flip probability across classes sitting at different distances from the hull.

The matched comparison is the weakest step. Four-element known cells are small (n = 108 to 297), "known" means previously catalogued including theoretical entries, the comparison is unmatched on hull distance (Section 4.11), and it is the comparison most exposed to selection on the candidates themselves. We treat it as exploratory throughout.

Partly unexplained features. Nickel's position at the global average despite receiving U is consistent with its nearly filled spin-up d bands limiting any meta-GGA moment enhancement (Section 4.3); the reversal of its anion-class ordering relative to iron and cobalt is not accounted for by that argument, or by any other we can test here. The triclinic excess is unexplained.

Scope. The GNoME results apply to materials with at most four elements that were selected for r^{2}SCAN recomputation; the 266 recomputed quinaries (229 of them matched to the summary file) are included in the global rate but support no stratified claim. Sections 4.11 and 4.14 additionally report quantities computed on Materials Project entries, which are drawn from a different population and are labelled as such throughout.

8 Conclusion

A single aggregate survival rate is not an adequate description of how far a generated catalogue's stability labels depend on the workflow that produced them. Resolved by chemistry, the verdict-flip rate between GNoME's PBE($+U$) labels and its r^{2}SCAN recomputations ranges from 4.0% [3.3, 4.7] for plain quaternary intermetallics to 30.7% [27.7, 33.8] for lanthanide-free $3d$-containing quaternary oxides. The contrast persists under correction for non-independence among substitution-generated structures and under inverse-probability weighting for recomputation selection; a lanthanide-pooled form of it is present within every populated hull-distance band and every generation-pipeline and training-set split examined, and the $3d$-associated excess within every band-gap bin; its magnitude is substantially sensitive to the reference-set definition, the oxide-to-intermetallic ratio running from 2.1 to 1.3 across the two sets we can compare.

An additive per-element account is not what the data look like: a composition-linear offset cancels from a decomposition energy by construction, and in a fitted model that allows context dependence an element's coefficient varies strongly with what it is combined with. Within a post-selected element set, cluster-robust joint tests reject equal context coefficients for iron, chromium, manganese and nickel and not for cobalt. Underlying the binary verdict is a chemistry-dependent difference in mean displacement on top of much larger scatter: +14.7 meV/atom for $3d$ oxides against −8.9 for plain intermetallics, with within-cell standard deviations of 24 to 56 meV/atom. Membership of the Materials Project Hubbard-U list is a strong observed compositional predictor, and selective application of U is not a sufficient explanation of the pattern: elevated disagreement persists outside the U-treated regime, and the highest within-class iron rates are in borides, pnictides and intermetallics, chemistry receiving no U. The smaller Fe-associated excess in oxides is consistent with partial suppression by the corrected treatment but does not establish it; for cobalt the reading is ambiguous, and nickel runs the other way. We do not test a physical mechanism; a plausible candidate is meta-GGA over-magnetisation of itinerant $3d$ systems. Lanthanide content is associated with a below-average rate overall, as the pre-committed claim anticipated (a claim informed by an earlier look at the same data), but the association reverses sign with the anion and is near zero when averaged over classes because within-class effects of opposite sign cancel.

For verification budgets, composition supplements proximity to the hull rather than replacing it. In cluster-held-out evaluation at a 20% entry-count budget, ranking by PBE hull distance alone surfaces 40.4% of disagreements and the combined policy 45.8%, against 37.6% for composition alone; the combined policy stays ahead by about six points of a twenty-bin nonparametric model of hull distance, and cross-fitting the estimated cell rates does not remove the gain. That is a held-out ranking result and not a claim about calibrated per-entry risk.

These findings concern sensitivity to computational workflow, not experimental accuracy: the released outcomes do not permit separate attribution of disagreement to functional choice, relaxation, empirical corrections and reference-phase coverage. The matched comparison against previously catalogued materials is exploratory, and coverage beyond four elements — the regime GNoME advertises most prominently — is insufficient for the stratified claims made here.

Data and code availability

All input data are public: the two GNoME CSV files are served from the DeepMind bucket `gs://gdm_materials_discovery/gnome_data/` (139,541 and 554,054 rows at the time of access, 9 October 2026), and the Materials Project thermo records were retrieved through the public API on 9–10 October 2026. Appendix E gives the full input manifest. The repository at https://github.com/FOUNDERACCRETION/gnome-audit contains the pre-committed decision rules with their commit history, one script per analysis phase, every machine-readable table and figure the paper draws on, pinned package versions, and a `run_all.py` driver that regenerates the results directory from the two CSV files and then checks the regenerated output against every number printed here: eighty-four headline quantities, the values parsed out of the LaTeX tables, and the prose. A continuous-integration workflow performs the whole regeneration on a clean runner on every push that touches the analysis code, after deleting the stored results so that the checks cannot pass on them. `VALIDATION.md` states what each check asserts and what none of them can establish. The only components not reproducible without credentials are the two Materials Project pulls, which require a free API key; their cached outputs are committed, and the Materials Project changes over time: a live re-pull on 22 October 2026 returned two additional boride/carbide/silicide entries and moved eight matched-cell interval endpoints by at most 0.2 points, with every point estimate unchanged. Reproducing a number is not the same as the number being right: these checks test consistency between code, results and manuscript, and they will pass on a statistical choice that is internally consistent and still wrong. `REVIEWER.md` names the definitions, encodings, contrasts and the propensity model as the places most worth doubting. At the time of writing the repository has not been deposited in a DOI-minting archive.

Disclosures

AI assistance. Claude (Anthropic) was used to assist with implementation of the analysis code and preparation of manuscript text. I independently defined the research question and scope, obtained the data, specified and committed the decision rules before the stratified analysis, executed the Materials Project queries, reviewed and tested the code and outputs, and revised the final manuscript. The verification actually performed is described above, under Data and code availability, and in the next paragraph, rather than asserted here. All analytical decisions, interpretations and claims are my responsibility. The complete code, machine-readable outputs, validation checks and reproducibility workflow are publicly available.

Every reference has been checked against the publisher, journal or arXiv record. The following numerical and interpretive claims were additionally checked against the source text rather than against the citation alone: Merchant et al.'s 84%, 86.8% and 90% figures, their 381,000 and 421,000 counts and the 232,477 attributed to symmetry-aware partial substitution (Merchant et al., 2023); the Materials Project correction scheme's fourteen corrected anion species and its restriction of the Hubbard U to eight transition metals in oxides and fluorides (Materials Project, 2026a); the 6,307 materials behind Kingsbury et al.'s "approximately 6000 solids" and their conclusion that r^{2}SCAN predicts formation energies more accurately than both SCAN and PBEsol (Kingsbury et al., 2022a); Kothakonda et al.'s conclusion that GGAs are comparable to meta-GGAs for transition metals, intermetallics and weakly bound solids, and that PBE is slightly more accurate for the 233 Type 2 decomposition enthalpies (Kothakonda et al., 2023); An et al.'s 603-to-298, 166 and 109 counts, the use of SCAN rather than r^{2}SCAN for their refinement, and the exclusion of 142 rare-earth compounds for reasons of f-electron and pseudopotential uncertainty (An et al., 2026); Yu et

al.'s 19,998 unary and binary materials and their per-element formation-energy error metric (Yu et al., 2024); and Huang et al.'s 380,190 paired MatPES entries together with their thermodynamic validation on six binary systems, Fe–O, Mn–O, Ti–Cl, Mo–Cl, V–S and Cu–S (Huang et al., 2026). The "more than 60% metallic" figure of Liu and Meng (Liu and Meng, 2024) is cited as reported and is not used in any analysis; the anion-class mix is measured directly in this paper (Table 13). The remaining references were verified for existence, authorship and venue but not claim by claim.

Competing interests: I am the founder of Accretion Labs, a materials-informatics company.

A Cell-level results with cluster bootstrap intervals

This appendix lists all disjoint cells with $n \geq 500$. Intervals resample prototype clusters. The final column is the ratio of the cluster interval width to the naive Wald binomial width.

Table 16: Flip rate by composition cell, all disjoint cells with $n \geq 500$, with cluster bootstrap 95% intervals and the widening factor relative to the naive binomial interval.

n_{el}	Anion	Ln	3d	n	Rate	Cluster 95% CI	Widen
4	oxide	no	yes	2,478	30.7%	[27.7, 33.8]	1.69
3	chalcogenide	no	yes	564	30.3%	[24.9, 36.5]	1.53
4	pnictide	yes	yes	4,573	30.1%	[25.9, 33.8]	2.96
3	boride/carbide/silicide	no	yes	575	29.6%	[24.1, 35.3]	1.51
4	boride/carbide/silicide	no	yes	4,501	25.2%	[21.5, 29.5]	3.14
3	pnictide	no	yes	813	24.0%	[19.9, 28.7]	1.51
4	boride/carbide/silicide	yes	yes	4,561	22.8%	[18.5, 27.4]	3.65
4	halide	no	yes	794	22.4%	[17.5, 27.9]	1.80
3	oxide	no	no	921	21.7%	[18.7, 24.9]	1.17
3	intermetallic	no	yes	2,667	21.1%	[18.4, 24.0]	1.80
3	intermetallic	yes	yes	2,056	19.0%	[15.9, 22.4]	1.91
4	oxide	no	no	3,318	18.9%	[16.7, 21.4]	1.79
4	oxide	yes	yes	1,399	18.1%	[14.2, 22.0]	1.94
4	pnictide	no	yes	5,736	17.8%	[14.7, 21.0]	3.18
3	halide	no	no	1,326	17.3%	[14.3, 20.8]	1.60
3	pnictide	yes	no	1,349	16.8%	[11.9, 22.4]	2.63
4	chalcogenide	no	yes	1,487	16.3%	[13.4, 19.7]	1.67
4	pnictide	yes	no	7,412	13.9%	[11.5, 16.5]	3.15
4	oxide	yes	no	4,232	13.8%	[11.4, 16.6]	2.52
4	halide	no	no	1,404	13.1%	[10.2, 16.6]	1.82
4	intermetallic	yes	yes	10,659	12.9%	[11.6, 14.5]	2.27
3	oxide	yes	no	730	12.2%	[7.7, 16.9]	1.93
4	intermetallic	no	yes	7,459	12.1%	[10.7, 13.5]	1.88
3	boride/carbide/silicide	no	no	845	11.7%	[9.0, 14.9]	1.36
3	pnictide	no	no	1,473	11.1%	[8.9, 13.6]	1.47
3	halide	yes	no	982	10.6%	[6.7, 15.8]	2.37
3	chalcogenide	no	no	1,106	10.6%	[8.4, 13.0]	1.26
3	chalcogenide	yes	no	1,076	10.1%	[7.4, 13.7]	1.77
3	boride/carbide/silicide	yes	no	1,246	9.6%	[6.1, 13.9]	2.37
4	halide	yes	yes	1,119	9.1%	[5.3, 14.5]	2.74
4	boride/carbide/silicide	yes	no	10,287	9.1%	[7.0, 11.4]	4.02
4	chalcogenide	yes	no	1,497	8.4%	[6.3, 10.7]	1.59
4	boride/carbide/silicide	no	no	3,422	8.2%	[6.8, 9.7]	1.59
3	intermetallic	no	no	2,618	7.9%	[6.6, 9.3]	1.30
4	chalcogenide	no	no	1,467	7.0%	[5.5, 8.7]	1.22
3	intermetallic	yes	no	4,661	6.4%	[5.0, 8.0]	2.11
4	pnictide	no	no	4,675	6.0%	[4.8, 7.3]	1.82

n_{el}	Anion	Ln	$3d$	n	Rate	Cluster 95% CI	Widen
4	halide	yes	no	3,599	5.9%	[2.8, 10.8]	5.16
4	intermetallic	yes	no	18,932	5.5%	[4.6, 6.3]	2.59
4	intermetallic	no	no	5,025	4.0%	[3.3, 4.7]	1.31

Median widening factor 1.82. The highest and lowest quaternary cells remain disjoint: 30.7% [27.7, 33.8] against 4.0% [3.3, 4.7].

B Per-element results

This appendix lists all 83 elements appearing in at least 300 recomputed materials, ordered by flip rate and read left to right across the three column groups. Point estimates; cluster bootstrap intervals for the extremes are given in Section 4.2. An asterisk marks the 53 elements whose contrast against the global rate survives Benjamini–Hochberg correction at 0.05. Each element is contrasted against a global rate that includes that element, which attenuates the contrast for the largest-n entries.

Table 17: Per-element flip rate for the 83 elements with $n \geq 300$; an asterisk marks a Benjamini–Hochberg-significant contrast against the global rate.

El.	n	Flip (%)	El.	n	Flip (%)	El.	n	Flip (%)
Fe*	5,762	42.8	Co*	10,972	33.2	Cr*	2,553	30.7
Mn*	4,994	25.2	F*	2,801	24.9	As*	6,298	21.6
Ce*	4,236	20.5	Mo*	3,910	20.2	Sb*	6,577	19.9
O*	13,668	19.3	V*	3,659	18.9	Si*	18,382	18.4
W*	3,223	18.2	Eu*	2,132	18.0	U*	2,595	17.9
Te*	2,207	17.4	Bi*	6,606	16.5	Ag*	4,224	16.3
Gd	976	16.0	Zr	7,315	14.7	P	10,265	14.2
Sc	7,842	13.9	Se	4,543	13.6	Ca	5,153	13.5
Au	5,932	13.5	S	3,383	13.4	Ni	10,142	13.4
Cl	2,172	13.2	Y	11,046	13.1	Ti	5,612	13.1
Hf	6,809	13.0	C	4,735	12.9	Ga	10,930	12.9
Dy	11,559	12.8	K	2,795	12.7	H	2,416	12.7
Cu	6,254	12.6	Ho	11,988	12.6	Pr	8,238	12.4
Sr	3,981	12.4	Sn	9,436	12.3	Lu	6,821	12.3
Li	6,305	12.2	Ba	3,580	12.1	Tb*	12,248	12.1
Nb	5,297	11.9	Tm*	10,154	11.8	Er*	10,434	11.6
Na	2,932	11.6	Ta*	5,021	11.3	Nd*	9,238	11.1
La*	6,546	11.0	Rb*	3,141	10.8	Pu	1,020	10.8
Br	3,440	10.6	Pb*	4,377	10.6	B*	9,496	10.6
Hg*	4,445	10.2	Cs*	2,973	10.1	Th*	7,632	9.9
Al*	11,933	9.7	Np*	1,387	9.7	Zn*	7,510	9.1
Cd*	5,356	9.0	In*	8,259	9.0	Os*	8,652	8.9
N*	3,845	8.7	Pd*	10,381	8.1	Re*	3,958	8.1
Ru*	12,381	8.1	Sm*	4,852	8.0	I*	3,091	7.9
Pt*	13,450	7.8	Ge*	4,764	7.6	Rh*	14,340	7.3
Yb*	6,265	7.1	Be*	2,799	6.5	Ir*	15,680	6.2
Tc*	7,350	5.7	Mg*	4,073	5.7	Pm*	389	4.4
Pa*	4,251	3.6	Ac*	2,181	1.4			

C Implementation details

This appendix gives enough detail to re-derive the central inferences without reading the code. Every item below is implemented in the repository script named beside it.

Cluster bootstrap (`phase2.py`, `phase7_cluster.py`, `phase16_excess_ci.py`). The resampling unit is the structural prototype, the pair (space group number as recorded in the r^{2}SCAN file, anonymised stoichiometry); compositions are used as released, not reduced, and no structure matching is performed. Each replicate draws G clusters with replacement from the G clusters present in the relevant subset and concatenates their members, so replicate sample size varies. Intervals are percentile intervals at 2.5 and 97.5. Cell intervals and the per-element analysis use 20,000 replicates; the within-anion excesses 100,000; the matched-cell comparison of Section 4.11 20,000; the coarser-clustering check 20,000; and the average marginal effects 1,000 refits, since each replicate there refits the interaction model. The primary seed is `numpy.random.default_rng(20261009)`; the average marginal effects and the matched known-materials comparisons use 20261011, the context-spread intervals pool 20261009 and 20261012, and the seed-stability checks below use further seeds. Resampling is aggregated to the cluster level: drawing G prototypes with replacement has the same distribution as multinomial counts over them, so a replicate is a matrix-vector product against per-cluster count and flip-sum vectors. Replicates in which either arm of a contrast is empty are dropped.

The cluster pool is in every case the set of prototypes present in the subset being resampled. Cell intervals resample the prototypes within the cell; per-element rates and the element-versus-global contrast both come from one full-pool draw per replicate, from which the element rate and the global rate are recomputed; within-anion excesses resample the prototypes of the anion class and recompute both rates from the same draw. In the matched comparison (`phase37_matched_cluster.py`) the GNoME side draws prototypes once per replicate across all twenty matched cells together, and the Materials Project side is resampled at the material level, the two sides independently; those intervals are cluster-adjusted on the GNoME side only.

Monte Carlo stability. Replicate counts are chosen so that the seed-to-seed movement of every endpoint we tested is below the precision it is printed to, with two exceptions noted below (the average marginal effects and the spread intervals of Table 3). On the lower endpoint of the Fe oxide excess, the spread across five seeds falls from 0.90 points at 400 replicates to 0.035 at 100,000, close to the $B^{-1/2}$ rate (`phase33_percentile_conv.py`); at 100,000 its upper endpoint moves 0.042 points across seeds. At 20,000 replicates the Benjamini–Hochberg set is the same 53 of 83 elements under all five seeds (at 300 replicates the count ranges from 51 to 53), and the headline endpoints [27.7, 33.8] and [3.3, 4.7] come from 100,000 replicates at one seed; at 600 replicates they move by up to 0.5 points across five seeds (`phase31_stability.py`), and the $B^{-1/2}$ scaling observed for the Fe oxide endpoint implies movement of order 0.04 points at 100,000. The average marginal effects are one exception, at 1,000 refits: the U-list endpoints move 0.03 and 0.05 points across two seeds, while the pooled lanthanide effect's upper endpoint moves 0.10 and should be read as +1.1 to +1.2. The spread intervals of Table 3 are the other, moving by up to 13 meV/atom between seeds as its caption states.

Element-versus-global contrasts (`phase8_referee.py`). The comparator is estimated from the same data, so the contrast is resampled jointly: each replicate draws one global set of clusters and recomputes both the element rate and the global rate from it, and the standard error is that

of the difference $D_e^{(b)} = \hat{p}_e^{(b)} - \hat{p}_{\text{global}}^{(b)}$. Resampling the element rate alone against a fixed global rate gives 51 significant contrasts after Benjamini–Hochberg rather than 53.

Regression encoding (`phase6b_logit.py`, `phase10_robust.py`). `has_U` is 1 if the composition contains any of V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, W or Mo; `has_3d_nonU` is 1 only if it contains one of Sc, Ti, Cu or Zn *and* no U-list element; `has_Ln` is independent of both. The five anion dummies follow the priority rule of Section 3.4, with intermetallic and hydride pooled as the reference; element count and log sites are z-scored. Coefficients are fitted by iteratively reweighted least squares; all models converged. With 8,429 clusters the omitted finite-cluster factor $G/(G-1)$ is 1.0001.

Context-dependence model (`phase14b_additivity.py`, identification and inference in `phase43_context_identify.py`). Table 3 comes from an ordinary-least-squares fit of $\Delta = \sum_e c_e x_e + \sum_{e \in S} \sum_{a \in A} \gamma_{ea}\, x_e \mathbb{1}[\text{class} = a] + \varepsilon$ on the 117,018 matched, PBE-stable materials, where x_e is the atomic fraction of element e in the released (unreduced) composition, the first sum runs over the 83 elements present in this subset (ytterbium is absent), $S = \{\text{Fe, Co, Ni, Mn, Cr}\}$ and A is the six non-hydride anion classes. There is no intercept, and the interaction block is not reference-coded: an interaction is kept when at least 100 materials carry the element in that class, which retains all six non-hydride contexts for every element of S and drops the hydride context for each (nickel, at 99, is the nearest), giving 30 interaction terms and 113 columns. The design is full rank (numerical rank 113 of 113 at tolerance 1.6×10^{-9}, condition number 7.0×10^2), but narrowly. For each $e \in S$ the sum of its six interaction columns equals its main-effect column on every row except hydride-class materials, so the transformation $c_e \to c_e + t$, $\gamma_{ea} \to \gamma_{ea} - t$ for every non-hydride context a leaves every non-hydride fitted value unchanged; only the hydride rows, of which 286 contain a listed element (99 Ni, 84 Co, 62 Fe, 34 Cr, 7 Mn), anchor that direction. Deleting them drops the numerical rank to 111 with condition number 1.8×10^9. The main-effect *levels* therefore rest on a few hundred rows and are not physical contributions. What the table reports is unaffected, because a within-element contrast $(c_e + \gamma_{ea}) - (c_e + \gamma_{eb}) = \gamma_{ea} - \gamma_{eb}$ is invariant under that transformation; the driver asserts that all 75 such contrasts have inner product exactly zero with each of the five near-dependency directions and are invariant under column scaling and permutation to 1.6×10^{-12} meV/atom. The spread intervals are cluster bootstraps over structural prototypes, 1,965 replicates pooled over two seeds (965 at the first, 1,000 at the second; the driver reproduces both runs), each refitting all 113 columns. The test is the cluster-robust Wald test of Table 4, on the joint null $\gamma_{ea_1} = \cdots = \gamma_{ea_6}$ for each e, using the sandwich covariance over the 7,822 prototypes with the finite-cluster correction $\frac{G}{G-1} \cdot \frac{n-1}{n-K}$, and Benjamini–Hochberg across the five elements. The element set S was chosen after seeing the per-element ranking, so the test is conditional on that choice.

Propensity weighting (`phase9_selection.py`, diagnostics in `phase26_diag.py`). The model is fitted on all 371,870 summary entries with at most four elements, predicting recomputation from anion class, lanthanide and 3*d* flags, element count, log sites and PBE decomposition energy, which enters linearly and as its square on the standardised scale because coverage is not monotone in that energy. Weighted outcomes are computed on the 116,789 recomputed, PBE-stable entries. Over the 365,504 PBE-stable $\leq$4-element summary entries the fitted propensity has median 0.2995 and minimum $e^{-500} \approx 7.1 \times 10^{-218}$, the underflow limit of the fit, on entries that were not recomputed; among weighted entries the minimum is 1.52×10^{-6} and the median 0.3445, against 0.2752 for the unrecomputed. Weights are the inverse fitted probability floored at 10^{-2}; untrimmed, the largest weight is 6.6×10^5 and the weighted rate reads 3.05%, an artefact of a handful of entries. At the floor the largest weight is 100, the heaviest 1% of entries carry 3.3% of the total weight, and the

estimate is 12.71%.

Budget evaluation (`phase12_budget_baselines.py`, `phase24_budget_strong.py`). Eligibility is applied before splitting. Cells absent from the estimation set receive that set's global rate; no shrinkage is applied to small-cell estimates. The combined policy's cell rate is a generated regressor; `phase24_budget_strong.py` tests that on 20 fresh splits by cross-fitting the cell rates, dividing the estimation half into five folds by prototype cluster, and the held-out margin over a twenty-bin nonparametric hull-distance model is +6.31 points cross-fitted against +6.00 not. The uniform-random row is the analytic expectation $\lfloor bN \rfloor / N$, not a simulation; per-split values are written to `results/budget_repeated.csv`.

D All matched cells against known materials

Table 18 lists all twenty cells of Section 4.11: the ten of Table 11 together with the ten whose intervals straddle zero, under the same cell thresholds, bootstrap and conventions as that table. Positive δ means GNoME disagrees more; $*$ marks the ten that exclude zero. This table, Table 11 and the standardised contrasts of Section 4.11 are all generated by `phase37_matched_cluster.py`.

Table 18: All twenty matched cells, GNoME against Materials Project previously catalogued materials; conventions as in Table 11; δ is computed from unrounded rates and $*$ marks intervals excluding zero.

Cell	n_G	GNoME	n_K	Known	δ	95% CI
4-el oxide, 3*d*	2,478	30.7%	180	13.3%	+17.3	[+11.4, +23.0] *
3-el chalcogenide, 3*d*	564	30.3%	450	17.8%	+12.5	[+6.0, +19.4] *
3-el bor./carb./sil., 3*d*	575	29.6%	454	18.3%	+11.3	[+4.6, +18.0] *
3-el halide, no Ln/3*d*	1,326	17.3%	1,125	9.2%	+8.2	[+4.7, +11.9] *
4-el oxide, no Ln/3*d*	3,318	18.9%	297	10.8%	+8.2	[+3.9, +12.4] *
3-el oxide, no Ln/3*d*	921	21.7%	1,553	16.7%	+5.0	[+1.4, +8.6] *
3-el pnictide, no Ln/3*d*	1,473	11.1%	852	6.9%	+4.1	[+1.3, +7.1] *
3-el pnictide, 3*d*	813	24.0%	557	20.3%	+3.7	[−1.7, +9.5]
3-el chalcogenide, no Ln/3*d*	1,106	10.6%	1,064	7.4%	+3.2	[+0.5, +6.0] *
3-el bor./carb./sil., Ln	1,246	9.6%	674	7.1%	+2.5	[−1.5, +7.2]
3-el chalcogenide, Ln	1,076	10.1%	442	7.9%	+2.2	[−1.6, +6.5]
3-el bor./carb./sil., no Ln/3*d*	845	11.7%	448	9.6%	+2.1	[−1.8, +6.1]
4-el oxide, Ln	4,232	13.8%	108	12.0%	+1.8	[−5.2, +8.2]
3-el pnictide, Ln	1,349	16.8%	422	15.4%	+1.4	[−4.7, +8.0]
3-el oxide, Ln	730	12.2%	669	12.7%	−0.5	[−5.8, +4.8]
3-el intermetallic, Ln, 3*d*	2,056	19.0%	1,153	20.6%	−1.5	[−5.4, +2.5]
3-el intermetallic, 3*d*	2,667	21.1%	1,125	23.1%	−2.0	[−5.7, +1.8]
3-el halide, Ln	982	10.6%	434	14.8%	−4.2	[−9.3, +1.9]
3-el intermetallic, Ln	4,661	6.4%	1,988	13.0%	−6.6	[−8.7, −4.5] *
3-el intermetallic, no Ln/3*d*	2,618	7.9%	1,144	15.7%	−7.7	[−10.2, −5.3] *

E Input manifest

Licensing. GNoME data are released under the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial 4.0 International licence and the accompanying code under Apache 2.0 (GNoME dataset, 2023);

they are used here for non-commercial research. This paper's repository redistributes no GNoME records: it holds code, input checksums and derived aggregate statistics, the largest GNoME-derived result file carrying 83 rows of per-element summaries. The two per-material files it does commit are Materials Project extracts, used under that project's Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 terms with the attribution recorded in `results/PROVENANCE.md` (Jain et al., 2013).

Files. Two CSV files were downloaded from `gs://gdm_materials_discovery/gnome_data/` on 9 October 2026; the checksums are of the files as downloaded, before any processing.
`stable_materials_summary.csv`: 554,054 rows, 151,452,777 bytes, SHA-256
`c37bffb9dd6c51d38d259a2d340ecf796194729f656d474828512390db1ff0c9`
`stable_materials_r2scan.csv`: 139,541 rows, 22,004,293 bytes, SHA-256
`6a811395b065f43ae7911597405eec0ecfa88251e918f4c0ba8e4e99a75656fd`

Columns, missing values and joins. From the summary file we read `MaterialId`, `Decomposition Energy Per Atom MP`, `Decomposition Energy Per Atom All`, `Elements`, `Composition`, `NSites`, `Bandgap`, `Crystal System`, `Data Directory` and `Is Train`. From the r^{2}SCAN file we read the same identifier, element and composition fields, its `Decomposition Energy Per Atom MP`, `MP OQMD` and `All` columns, and `Space Group Number`, `Crystal System` and `NSites`. Decomposition energies are in eV/atom and band gaps in eV, as released. `Elements` is parsed with `ast.literal_eval` into a set; `Composition` is parsed with the regular expression `([A-Z][a-z]?)(\d+)` and is *not* reduced. Energy and gap fields are coerced with `pandas.to_numeric(errors="coerce")`; rows with a missing r^{2}SCAN decomposition energy are dropped before any analysis, and the band-gap accounting of Section 4.7 separates missing, infinite, zero and positive values. The two files are joined on `MaterialId`, which is unique in both files, so no duplicate resolution is required. The 22,498 r^{2}SCAN identifiers absent from the summary file are consistent with a release-version mismatch, which we state as a hypothesis not confirmed with the dataset authors.

Materials Project queries. Thermo records were retrieved through the public API on 9–10 October 2026 from https://api.materialsproject.org/materials/thermo/, paging at `_per_page=1000`. The `thermo_types` parameter is passed once per pull with the literal values `r2SCAN` and `GGA_GGA+U` exactly as spelled; the capitalisation is the API's and is not interchangeable, and we observed the upper-case `R2SCAN` of the client's `ThermoType` enumeration return zero documents without raising an error, so the spelling is worth pinning in any replication. The `_fields` parameter is the literal string `material_id,thermo_type,energy_above_hull,nelements,chemsys`; no other filter is applied. Stability is defined as $E_{\text{hull}} \leq 10^{-6}$ eV/atom on each side. Records are collapsed to one value per `material_id`; we checked the cached responses and found zero duplicate `(material_id, thermo_type)` combinations, 152,426 unique identifiers of 152,426 rows for `GGA_GGA+U` and 37,123 of 37,123 for r^{2}SCAN. The pulls are cached in `results/mp_gga_raw.csv` and `results/mp_r2scan_raw.csv`; they are the only components of the pipeline that require credentials, and the stored copies are reused by the continuous-integration run.

F Flip rate against threshold

Table 19 shows seven of the eleven thresholds computed, omitting $\tau = 15$, 25, 35 and 45 meV/atom and the pnictide column for width; the pnictide series on the eleven-point grid $\tau = 0$, 5, 10, 15, 20, 25,

Table 19: Flip rate by anion class as the disagreement threshold τ is raised; B/C/Si is the boride, carbide and silicide class.

τ (eV/atom)	Overall	B/C/Si	Chalc.	Halide	Hydride	Interm.	Oxide
0.000	13.0%	15.0%	12.1%	11.5%	12.0%	9.2%	19.3%
0.005	9.3%	11.3%	8.0%	8.2%	8.6%	5.4%	15.5%
0.010	7.1%	8.6%	6.0%	6.4%	6.0%	3.9%	12.5%
0.020	4.5%	5.2%	3.8%	3.6%	4.3%	2.3%	8.6%
0.030	3.0%	3.5%	2.6%	2.2%	2.5%	1.5%	6.1%
0.040	2.1%	2.6%	2.0%	1.5%	1.7%	1.0%	4.2%
0.050	1.6%	2.1%	1.6%	1.2%	1.1%	0.8%	3.2%

30, 35, 40, 45 and 50 meV/atom is 16.7%, 12.8%, 10.3%, 8.3%, 6.6%, 5.2%, 4.3%, 3.6%, 3.0%, 2.5% and 2.2%. The full seven-class series at all eleven thresholds is in `results/threshold_curves.csv`.

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